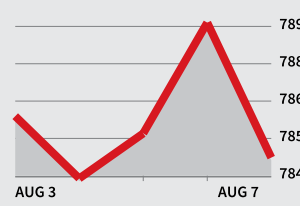


SENSEX 78499.17 (-455.59)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24570.65	-65.35
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.87	-0.13
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.20	-0.02
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	149022.00	+1176
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	231381.00	+5707



BULLION BOOST.

Gold ETF inflows reached \$1.3 billion, while US-led outflows totalled \$900 million last week globally: World Gold Council **p10**

AUTO FOCUS.

Toyota's 9th gen Hilux improves styling and refinement while retaining its rugged capabilities **p4**

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

QUICKLY.

ECONOMIC EDGE

Supply-side strengthened amid global shocks: CEA



New Delhi: India's ability to sustain high economic growth while bringing down public debt and fiscal deficit reflects a significant improvement in the economy's supply-side potential, even as the country faces a challenging global environment over the next two decades, Chief Economic Adviser V Anantha Nageswaran said. He said the economy had demonstrated resilience despite facing a series of major external shocks. **p3**

PEOPLE FIRST

AP unveils pedestrian safety policy

Hyderabad: In a first among the States, the Andhra Pradesh government has unveiled its Pedestrian Safety & Universal Accessibility Policy, 2026, bringing together pedestrian safety, universal design, scientific road audits and tech-driven monitoring. The policy was approved by the Cabinet on Thursday to fundamentally change the way roads and streets are planned, built and monitored. **p11**

CBI chargesheet exposes NEET paper leak network

THE PLOT. Agency traces how papers moved from subject experts to students via middlemen

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

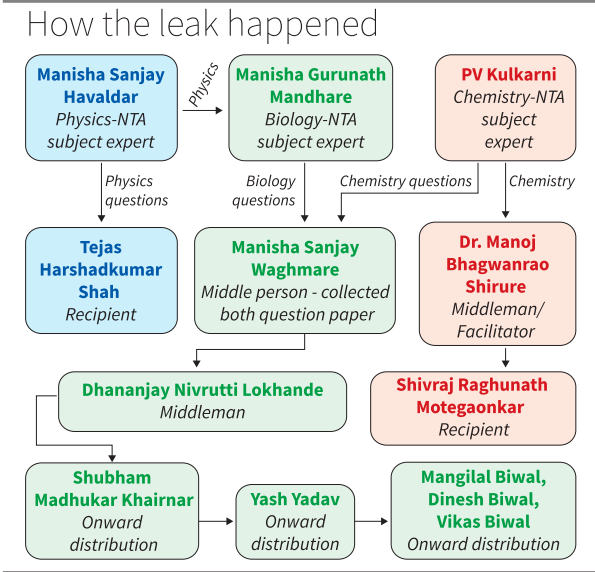
The CBI chargesheet in the NEET-UG 2026 examination paper leak scandal shows that questions were allegedly passed from NTA-appointed subject experts to middlemen and finally to candidates, both physically and through social media platforms including WhatsApp and Telegram, all in exchange for money.

The CBI filed a chargesheet before a Special CBI court here on July 28 against 13 persons, who are now in judicial custody.

WHATSAPP GROUP

The chargesheet — a copy of which is with *businessline* — mentions a WhatsApp group, called 'FIFA World Cup 2026', that worked as a magnet for students to get enrolled in a web of operators who leaked papers. There were eight students in this group, along with a subject expert who provided them with questions that would appear in the NEET exam.

According to the CBI, Manisha Sanjay Havaladar, physics subject expert; Man-



isha Gurunath Mandhare (biology); and PV Kulkarni (chemistry) allegedly emerged as kingpins of the scandal. The probe agency said, "The experts concerned have full access to final sets of questions."

THE MODUS OPERANDI

The three Maharashtra-based experts were in touch with one another and from them, the questions went to the second rung of a ring of

middlemen and facilitators, and eventually to students in exchange for bribes at different levels.

Manisha Sanjay Havaladar — resident of Laxminivas Apartment, Gadgil Street, Pune — slipped 60-66 handwritten physics questions to middleman Tejas Harshadkumar Shah, Chief Operating Officer at Dr Abhang Prabhu Medical Academy, Pune. Manisha Gurunath Mandhare — taking coach-

ing classes at her residence at Ganga Osian Park, Sukh Sagar, Pune — handed over the biology questions to Manisha Sanjay Waghmare.

She also got the chemistry paper from Kulkarni and transferred it to middleman Dhananjay Nivrutti Lokhande for onward distribution.

Kulkarni passed on the chemistry questions to Waghmare and Manoj Bhagwanrao Shirure, owner of Shidhivinayak Hospital in Latur. Shirure paid Kulkarni ₹5 lakh, which he then gave to Shivraj Raghunath Mategoankar, Managing Partner of Renukai Career Centre in Latur.

The CBI stated that experts were provided with plain sheets inside the confidential section of the NTA main office in the NSIC building, Okhla, Delhi, for rough work during translation and back translation.

Kulkarni "used these sheets to note down, on small chits, all 135 chemistry questions in brief and the answer options and took them out in a concealed manner." When it came to easier questions, he would simply memorise and write them down.

INSIDE

Jewellery, watches drive Titan's strong Q1 growth

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Retail major Titan Company posted a total income of ₹20,212 crore in the June quarter, a 40 per cent increase from the year-ago period. The performance was led by a 36 per cent increase in its jewellery business.

Within jewellery, the combined total income of Tanishq, Mia, Zoya and beYon grew 38 per cent from the June 2025 quarter to ₹15,502 crore, while CaratLane reported a 40 per cent increase to ₹1,441 crore.

The company's consolidated profit after tax rose nearly 63 per cent from the year-ago period to ₹1,777 crore.

Report on p2

Reserve Bank rejects Religare's demerger scheme

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India has rejected the proposed demerger scheme that sought to transfer Religare Enterprises' lending and financial services business to its subsidiary, Religare Finvest (RFL).

Under the proposed scheme of arrangement, RFL was to retain its stake in Care Health Insurance and continue as an insurance-focused entity.

The financial services business, comprising lending, broking, investment activities and related ancillary and support services, was proposed to be transferred to RFL on a going-concern basis.

Read more on p5

Godrej Consumer reports 19% Q1 revenue growth

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Godrej Consumer Products Ltd on Friday reported consolidated revenue from operations of ₹4,225 crore for the quarter ended June, a 19 per cent increase from the year-ago period.

The growth was backed by an underlying volume growth of 9 per cent.

The consolidated net profit came in at ₹505 crore, up 11 per cent y-o-y, while its EBITDA grew 14 per cent during the period.

On a standalone basis, the company's revenue grew 12 per cent y-o-y to ₹2,535 crore, while the standalone EBITDA and PAT came in at ₹548 crore and ₹363 crore, respectively.

Read more on p2

Hindalco Q1 net up 75% on strong metal prices

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Hindalco Industries, the Aditya Birla Group's flagship metals company, reported a 75 per cent increase in its June quarter net profit to ₹7,013 crore compared with ₹4,004 crore a year ago, on the back of firm metal prices and low-cost inventory.

Revenue jumped 32 per cent to ₹84,825 crore (₹64,232 crore).

EBITDA was up 73 per cent to ₹14,989 crore (₹8,673 crore) as LME aluminium prices rose to \$3,577 a tonne from \$2,447.

Upstream aluminium EBITDA per tonne was up to \$2,331 (\$1,467). However, sales volumes rose only 3 per cent to 3.35 lakh tonnes.

Read more on p2

CLOUD COVER



ORANGE ALERT. Clouds rise over Shimla after a spell of rain. Himachal Pradesh is grappling with the closure of 162 roads, disruption of 73 water supply schemes and damage to 105 transformers due to heavy rain. Shimla received 55 mm rain in the 24 hours since Thursday evening. The Shimla Meteorological Office issued an orange alert, warning of more heavy rainfall in Kangra, Kullu, Mandi and Sirmour districts on August 10, and Chamba, Kullu, Mandi and Sirmour districts on August 11 **p11**

Astrobase unveils Everest, India's first FFSC engine built for reusable rockets

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Space-tech company Astrobase Space Technologies has unveiled what it describes as India's first privately developed 800 kN full-flow staged combustion (FFSC) rocket engine Everest, entering one of the most demanding engine architectures, often described in the industry as the "Holy Grail" of rocket propulsion.

The company is targeting the first flight of its reusable launch vehicle for December 2028, with the engine's hot-fire campaign scheduled to begin in the coming months

THE TECH

The unveiling puts Astrobase among a group of companies pursuing one of the most complex rocket-engine architectures in the world, with SpaceX's Raptor cur-



Everest, the 800 kN full-flow staged combustion LOX-methane rocket engine

rently the only FFSC engine to have successfully flown to space. FFSC is considered challenging because both the fuel and oxidiser are fully gasified before entering the combustion chamber. This allows the engine to operate at higher chamber pressures and extract greater efficiency from the propellant while reducing some of the thermal stresses associated with con-

ventional engine architectures. Everest is an 800 kN-class LOX-methane engine, and Astrobase plans to use it as the propulsion system for its planned reusable launch vehicle.

The company is also looking beyond the engine, with plans to build an industrial-scale propulsion manufacturing capability. Its facilities are being designed to produce up to 50 engines a year.

In Phase 1, it aims to enable around 100 tonnes of annual launch capacity, with plans to scale this to more than 1,000 tonnes in Phase 2 through a higher launch cadence.

At full capacity, the company expects its facilities to be capable of manufacturing and hot-firing roughly one high-thrust engine a week.

BUILDING AN ECOSYSTEM

"Everest is not a standalone technology demonstration;

it represents the foundation of an industrial capability that India will increasingly need in the years ahead," said Neeraj Khandelwal, Co-Founder and CEO, Astrobase Space Technologies.

He said the next phase would focus on building industrial readiness and launch cadence required to serve both national priorities and the expanding global commercial space market.

Astronaut Shubhanshu Shukla congratulated the team on X, describing FFSC as one of rocketry's most demanding engineering challenges.

For Astrobase, however, the harder chapter begins now. The company must take Everest from the unveiling stage to a successful hot-fire test and prove that its high-thrust propulsion technology can survive the demands of a reusable launch vehicle.

Rice prices on the boil in domestic market on demand-supply gap, fears of deficient rain

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Rice prices, particularly of non-basmati varieties, in the domestic market have increased over 10 per cent in the past few weeks due to a demand-supply gap and fears of a deficient monsoon, industry stakeholders said.

The Centre's decision to increase the Minimum Support Price (MSP) for paddy during the 2026-27 crop year (July-June) to ₹2,441 a quintal (up from ₹2,369) for the common variety also aided the uptrend, said Rajesh Jain Paharia, a New Delhi-based exporter.

SUPPLY DEFICIT

The demand-supply gap is more for premium varieties such as Sona Masuri, Ponni and Masuri.

However, its impact is felt

even on broken rice prices.

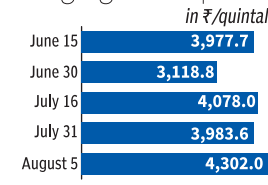
"Though rice prices are up, they seem to have stabilised for now. But millers say prices usually rise at this point in time and this year, the increase is more. They are reporting a slight shortage in paddy," said M Madan Prakash, President of the Tamil Nadu Agri Commodities Exporters Association.

INFLATION IMPACT

"It is a case of demand and supply despite the Centre saying rice production was at a record high in the 2026-26 crop year. This might result in a rise in the headline inflation, as the RBI fears," said a New Delhi-based analyst, adding that millers do not have ample supplies.

Paharia said the price rise is primarily due to the supply-demand situation. "Prices of some premium varieties have increased, and

Surging cereal price



Source: Agmarket.gov.in

are reflecting across all varieties," he said.

MARKET UPSWING

"Prices have gone up for premium white, parboiled and steamed rice. Quality old white rice commands up to ₹1,900 per 26-kg bag, while the new one costs ₹1,600," said a Chennai trader.

Prices of rice have increased by at least ₹10 a kg as paddy rates have increased.

Prakash said prices of the

Swarna variety, available in West Bengal, had increased to ₹34 a kg ex-mill from ₹30 in the past few weeks.

The Delhi-based analyst said that due to a deficient monsoon, rice prices have tended to rise.

"Even basmati prices are up. The area under maize is low. As a result, rice will be in demand for ethanol production," he said.

As of Friday, the monsoon is 11 per cent deficient.

Prakash said that rice prices are up also because the arrivals of the zaid (summer) and rabi crops are over. The kharif arrivals are due only after October.

With the government sticking to the "historical statistics system", there is a gap in the production data. "Similarly, there could be some gap in the record stocks with the Food Corporation of India," he said.

QUICKLY.

Forex kitty swells by \$10.5 b to \$693 b



Mumbai: The country's forex reserves jumped by \$10.512 billion to \$ 692.866 billion during the week ended July 31, the RBI said on Friday. The overall kitty had jumped by \$6.118 billion to \$682.354 billion in the previous reporting week. For the week ended July 31, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased by \$8.75 billion to \$564.68 billion, the central bank's data showed.

NLC India Q1 net profit falls 48% to ₹436 crore

Chennai: NLC India reported a net profit of ₹436 crore for the quarter ended June 2026, down 48 per cent when compared to ₹839 crore in the same quarter last year. The profit in the year-ago quarter was higher due to a deferred tax adjustment of ₹425 crore. The company posted revenue from operations of ₹4,717 crore, up from ₹3,826 crore. Its coal production stood at 40.85 lakh tonnes.

India’s supply-side strengthened amid repeated global shocks: CEA

WORD OF CAUTION. The next 20 years will be more challenging, says Anantha Nageswaran

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India’s ability to sustain high economic growth while bringing down public debt and fiscal deficit reflects a significant improvement in the economy’s supply-side potential, even as the country faces a more challenging global environment over the next two decades, Chief Economic Adviser V Anantha Nageswaran said. Speaking at an Assocham FinTech event, Nageswaran said the economy had demonstrated resilience despite facing a series of major external shocks over the past decade, including the Covid-19 pandemic, the Russia-Ukraine war, the energy shock, supply chain disruptions, tariffs and geopolitical conflicts. Besides, Nageswaran said the government inherited an economy facing balance-sheet stress in the corporate and banking sectors, along with high fiscal and current account deficits.



TAKING STOCK. V Anantha Nageswaran (right), Chief Economic Adviser, at the Assocham FinTech event in New Delhi

The subsequent years, he pointed out were focused on repairing these balance sheets while undertaking structural reforms, such as the Goods and Services Tax and the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code. Infrastructure spending also began to increase from 2018-19, he said. However, even as corporate and banking-sector balance sheets were being repaired, the economy faced problems in housing finance and non-banking finance in 2018-19 and 2019-20, followed by Covid-19, the Russia-Ukraine war and the energy shock.

“Every year or two, there has been some major exogenous shock,” Nageswaran said. Despite these disruptions, India was among the few economies to sustain real growth of around 7 per cent in the post-Covid period, he said. Further, he cited the decline in fiscal deficit, which had fallen from 9.2 per cent to 4.4 per cent, while noting that India was among a small number of countries that had also reduced public debt ratio during the post-Covid period. Accordingly, the CEA said the enhancement in the economy’s supply-side potential

was a significant achievement.

FINANCIAL SECTOR

On the financial sector, Nageswaran said finance should be viewed as an enabling sector rather than the key driver of economic activity. According to him, fintech companies, which generally operate with smaller capital bases than well-capitalised banks, could make a difference, particularly in sectors, such as small and medium enterprises, self-employed businesses and retail finance. Nevertheless, the government should not sit in judgment over whether fintech companies were allocating capital in the most productive manner, as this should be determined by market participants. He cautioned against making the expansion of financial sector activity as a multiple of the gross domestic product a policy objective. On cross-border payments, Nageswaran said the growth of merchandise and

services trade between countries would ultimately drive greater use of the respective currencies and cross-border payment systems.

AI IMPACT

On artificial intelligence, Nageswaran said the focus should be on safety and security, particularly in the financial sector. He cautioned that artificial intelligence should not become a tool for exclusion, and said humans should remain in the loop as the technology develops. In addition, Nageswaran said the next 20 years would not resemble the previous three decades since the economic reforms of 1991. “We are going through structural breaks in many areas — climate, technology and geopolitics and supply chain weaponisation,” he said. He added that both the private and public sectors would need to “up our game substantially” over the next two decades as the global economic environment becomes more challenging.



Hardeep Singh Puri, Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas

‘OMCs began testing for E20 fuel contamination at pumps from mid-July’

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

Allaying fears of contamination of E20 fuel, Oil Minister Hardeep Singh Puri on Friday said that oil marketing companies (OMCs) started rigorous testing at retail outlets (ROs) from mid-July, collecting 2,000 samples per day.

Addressing CII’s International Energy Conference and Exhibition (IECE), the Minister revealed that only 4 cases of contamination of E20 fuel had been found.

Without naming SIAM’s July 28 letter to the government in which the industry body flagged concerns over high chloride and moisture contamination in E20 fuel, Puri said, “Some organisation wrote a letter. That letter, I think, was July 28. Two weeks before that we had started rigorous testing. They (OMCs) used to collect 2,000 samples from 2,000 ROs a day. They formed crack teams. Overall, they would have covered a very large number of pumps. They found 4 cases (of contamination) out of the 1,07,000 ROs.”

He said some people were trying to create controversy around the E20 fuel. India has around 1,07,000 retail outlets, which serve around 7 crore customers everyday, and only four contamination cases were

found. “Someone out there is trying to place something out of context,” he added.

SAMUDRA MANTHAN

Speaking about the Samudra Manthan, or the National Offshore Exploration Scheme, Puri said the intent is to encourage private players to enter the domestic E&P sector. “We have two (drilling) rigs operating just now and we are getting a third one with ONGC Chairman telling me that one rig costs \$3,00,000 per day or whereabouts. There are not too many rigs available in the world,” he added.

He stressed that deepwater exploration & production (E&P) requires heavy expenditure, financial support and a lot of perseverance. India is committed to explore its offshore deepwater and ultra deepwaters to search for hydrocarbons. On the West Asia conflict, he said India maintained uninterrupted fuel supplies despite disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz, the most critical energy chokepoint.

Claims of 500 ppm chloride and presence of moisture in E20 fuel not validated: OMCs

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The public sector oil marketing companies (OMCs) said on Friday that more than 100 randomly selected petrol samples tested across refineries confirms that chloride content is consistently low, with all samples reported at or below 1 ppm (parts per million). Further, a dedicated task force, having members of the three OMCs and the Centre for High Technology (CHT), checked ethanol samples from 80 distilleries across

India in the last 10 days with all samples having chloride content of less than 3 ppm. The OMCs also tested ethanol and E20 samples at depots and terminals. More than 80 samples were collected from various OMC terminals, which showed chloride content below 3 ppm, said a consolidated statement on behalf of the three OMCs — Indian Oil Corporation, Bharat Petroleum Corporation and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation. Under the intensified monitoring programme, more than 160 samples had been analysed for chloride



content in the last few days and the levels are in range of 0-3 ppm contrary to the claims of several hundred ppm, it added. The surveillance system identified only two isolated instances where elevated

chloride levels were detected. These were suspended immediately, followed by detailed root-cause analysis and implementation of appropriate corrective measures before restoration of supplies, the statement pointed out. On water ingress testing, the statement said about 90,000 retail outlets (ROs), or petrol pumps, had commenced mandatory inspection and monitoring of underground storage tanks. The underground tanks at ROs are being inspected 8-12 times every day and had not revealed any water in-

gress so far. The government has prescribed a stringent chloride specification for ethanol used in petrol blending and has instituted a high-frequency monitoring mechanism to ensure compliance across the entire supply chain.

UNDER SURVEILLANCE

Chloride monitoring is being done at multiple point of supply chain including refineries, distilleries, depots/terminals and retail outlets nationwide, confirming that quality is being consistently maintained throughout the supply chain.

Besides, OMCs have further strengthened surveillance by conducting water-ingress and density tests 8-12 times daily at every retail outlet. Mobile fuel quality testing laboratories had also been deployed across locations, while test results are being independently validated through fuel laboratories quality assurance, the statement said. Amid recent media reports on moisture and chloride in E20 petrol, OMCs carried out a nationwide intensive testing covering the entire EBMS supply chain, it added.

‘RE sector gains momentum with ₹5.25/unit RTC tariff discovery’

Our Bureau
New Delhi



Santosh Sarangi, MNRE Secretary

Highlighting the discovery of ₹5.25 per unit tariff for RTC renewable energy, Santosh Sarangi, Secretary for the Ministry of New & Renewable Energy (MNRE), on Friday, emphasised that the tariff demonstrates the growing competitiveness of the domestic renewable energy sector. The latest round-the-clock (RTC) RE bid discovered a competitive tariff of ₹5.25 a unit. The state-run renewable energy implementing agency (REIA), Solar Energy Corporation of India, conducted the bidding. “We expected the price to be very high, but thanks to the competitive spirit among our developers, we discovered a rate of ₹5.25 per unit for RE RTC,” Sarangi said. Addressing CII’s International Energy Conference and Exhibition, he said the latest RTC RE bid provides for 90 per cent assured power availability in each time block, with solar accounting for only 50 per cent of supply during the daytime.

The tariff demonstrates the growing competitiveness of renewable energy and developers’ ability to integrate solar, wind and storage technologies to provide reliable power, he added.

NON-FOSSIL CAPACITY

The MNRE Secretary said India had crossed 300 GW of renewable energy installations and is on course to achieve the Prime Minister’s target of 500 GW of non-fossil fuel capacity by 2030. He attributed this progress to three key pillars policy — certainty, domestic manufacturing and market-creation initiatives. Highlighting India’s growing renewable energy manufacturing ecosystem, Sarangi pointed out that the country had more than 213 GW of solar module manufacturing capacity and over 32 GW of solar cell manufacturing ca-

capacity, while around 85 per cent of wind energy manufacturing is indigenised. He highlighted the rapid expansion of decentralised renewable energy, noting that PM Surya Ghar had crossed 50 lakh households and is progressing towards its target of one crore rooftop solar installations. **INTEGRATED MARKET** Anura Karunathilake, Sri Lanka’s Minister of Energy, highlighted his country’s growing renewable energy potential and said its Electricity Act provided for the facilitation and promotion of a national electricity market, with cross-border electricity trading becoming a realistic possibility as the market matures. Referring to the proposed India-Sri Lanka grid interconnection, he said, “The future of energy in our region should not simply be about creating electricity. It should be about creating a resilient, interconnected and competitive regional electricity market that accelerates the clean energy transition, strengthens energy security and promotes sustainable economic growth for all our nations.”

LS clears MSME Bill to speed up payments

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Lok Sabha approved the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (Amendment) Bill, 2026, on Friday, aimed at strengthening the framework for resolving delayed payment disputes and enhancing the ease of doing business for the sector, after it was passed by the Rajya Sabha earlier this week. The Bill amends the MSME Development Act, 2006, with the objective of

addressing one of the sector’s biggest concerns — delayed payments — while simplifying the dispute resolution process, improving liquidity for small businesses and enhancing the ease of doing business. The Lok Sabha passed the legislation without a debate amid continued protests by the Opposition members over various issues. The Bill was approved by the Rajya Sabha on August 3 and has now completed its passage through Parliament. According to the government, the amendments seek

to strengthen the administrative framework governing MSMEs and introduce a more efficient mechanism for the settlement of payment disputes. “Its objective is to balance the interests of all concerned parties while maintaining constitutional principles and the interests of businesses,” MSME Minister Jitan Ram Manjhi told the Rajya Sabha on August 3. A key feature of the legislation is the introduction of strict timelines for adjudication of delayed payment cases to ensure faster resolution.

THE RAMCO CEMENTS LIMITED					
Regd. Office: “Ramamandiram”, Rajapalayam-626 117.					
Corporate Office: 98-A, Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai, Chennai 600 004.					
CIN :L26941TN1957PLC003566; E-mail: ksn@ramcocements.co.in					
EXTRACT OF CONSOLIDATED UN-AUDITED STATEMENT OF PROFIT AND LOSS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30 TH JUNE 2026					
Rs. in Crores					
S.No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended		Year Ended	
		Un-Audited	Audited [Refer Note No.6]	Un-Audited	Audited
		30-06-2026	31-03-2026	30-06-2025	31-03-2026
1.	Total Income	2,279.79	2,622.08	2,080.00	9,070.22
2.	Net Profit before exceptional items and tax	27.77	99.16	114.87	317.93
3.	Exceptional Items [Refer Note No.4]	12.62	74.17	-	553.17
4.	Net Profit for the period before tax	40.39	173.33	114.87	871.10
5.	Net Profit for the period after Tax attributable to				
	- Equity shareholders of the Parent	31.23	150.69	85.03	698.65
	- Non-Controlling Interest	0.01	0.03	(0.47)	0.14
	Total	31.24	150.72	84.56	698.79
6.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period after tax attributable to				
	- Equity shareholders of the Parent	31.09	147.15	90.80	699.17
	- Non-Controlling Interest	0.01	0.03	(0.44)	0.16
	Total	31.10	147.18	90.36	699.33
7.	Paid up Equity Share Capital	23.63	23.63	23.63	23.63
8.	Other Equity				8,069.88
9.	Securities Premium Account				50.59
10.	Net worth				8,093.88
11.	Paid up Debt Capital				3,852.05
12.	Capital Redemption Reserve				1.63
13.	Debenture Redemption Reserve				-
14.	Debt-Equity Ratio (in multiples)				0.48
15.	Debt Service Coverage Ratio (in multiples)				1.19
16.	Interest Service Coverage Ratio (in multiples)				3.04
17.	Earnings Per share of Re. 1/-each (Rs. p)				
	(Not Annualized)				
	Basic:	1.32	6.38	3.60	29.56
	Diluted:	1.32	6.38	3.60	29.56
Notes:-					
1. The above is an extract of the Quarterly Unaudited Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulations 33 & 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Un-Audited Financial Results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges at www.bseindia.com , and www.nseindia.com and on the Company's website at https://www.ramcocements.in/investors/financials					
2. For the other line items referred in regulation 52(4), 54(2) & (3) of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, pertinent disclosures have been made to the stock exchanges and can be accessed on the websites of the stock exchanges viz. www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com and that of the Company's website https://www.ramcocements.in/investors/financials					
3. The financial results have been prepared in accordance with Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS) prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with relevant rules thereunder and in terms of regulations 33 & 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (as amended). The said financial results were reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their Meetings held on 07-08-2026. The Statutory Auditors have carried out limited review of the above results and expressed an unmodified audit opinion.					
4. Exceptional Items comprises of -					
Rs. in Crores					
Particulars	Quarter Ended		Year Ended		
	Un-Audited	Audited [Refer Note No.6]	Un-Audited	Audited	
	30-06-2026	31-03-2026	30-06-2025	31-03-2026	
(a) Profit on sale of surplus lands	12.62	67.90	-	573.52	
(b) Impact on account of Social Security Code, 2025 due to Past Service Cost	-	6.27	-	(20.35)	
Total	12.62	74.17	-	553.17	
5. Key Standalone financial information					
Rs. in Crores					
Particulars	Quarter Ended		Year Ended		
	Un-Audited	Audited [Refer Note No.6]	Un-Audited	Audited	
	30-06-2026	31-03-2026	30-06-2025	31-03-2026	
Total Income	2,276.18	2,618.32	2,076.61	9,055.92	
Net Profit before tax	41.55	176.89	116.47	879.23	
Net Profit after tax	31.86	146.39	86.01	693.62	
6. The figures for the quarter ended 31-03-2026 are the balancing figures between audited results in respect of full financial year and published year to date upto the third quarter of the relevant financial year.					
7. The previous period figures have been re-grouped/re-stated wherever necessary.					
Chennai					
07-08-2026		For THE RAMCO CEMENTS LIMITED			
		M.F. FAROOQUI			
		CHAIRMAN			



QUICKLY.

Discover the updated Mahindra Scorpio N



The Scorpio N has received a host of new features and cosmetic updates as part of its facelift. Aside from new 18-inch dual-tone alloy wheels, a panoramic sunroof has made it to the Scorpio N for the first time. In addition, it gets a 540-degree surround-view camera, along with a 12.3-inch infotainment touchscreen and a 10.25-inch instrument display. Prices for the updated Scorpio N range from ₹13.6 lakh to ₹25.4 lakh (ex-showroom).

Range Rover SV Ultra launched at ₹3.8 crore



The Range Rover line-up has a new top-spec variant, and it's called the SV Ultra. Launched at ₹3.8 crore (ex-showroom), the SV Ultra features an excess of bespoke elements. Featuring exclusive Titan Silver paint, 22-inch alloys, a new interior colour scheme, a 21-speaker electrostatic sound system which works in sync with the seats and the haptic floor (also new), the SV Ultra appears set to raise the benchmark in go-anywhere entertainment. Also standard is the 4.4-litre twin-turbo V8 petrol engine!

Tata offers limited-edition Nexon in two colours



The Nexon can now be had in Camo Edition spec, which features exclusive colour options, camouflage-themed accents and equipment upgrades. Available in Creative (or higher) variants, the Nexon Camo Edition is being offered with two new colours, Munnar Mist and Coorg Cloud, a new 12.3-inch infotainment touchscreen and an integrated dashcam. You can have one in petrol, diesel and CNG options, and prices start at ₹9.99 lakh (ex-showroom).

@TheMotorGram



Big on Character

STANDOUT TRAITS. The largest Mini yet argues that character still counts in a segment where everything else is a bit, well, homogenous

Anubhav Sharma

The luxury compact SUV segment in India has become a comfortable place to shop and a difficult one to choose from. The BMW X1, the Mercedes-Benz GLA and the Audi Q3 are all competent, all similarly proportioned, and all have almost

the same feature lists. Mini, thankfully, has never worked that way. Since 1959, the brand has sold an idea first — a car that feels alive in your hands and looks like nothing else on the road — and it has stayed true to that philosophy even though the cars have grown in size. A big Mini sounds like an oxymoron, but it does have an audience and with the ‘Made in India’ tag, it has become relatively

affordable. The Countryman C looks like a Mini still, but one that has been inflated rather than redesigned. The octagonal grille, the short overhangs, the upright glasshouse and the jet-black roof are all carried over from the small cars, but scaled up. Adaptive LED headlights and matrix LED taillights get three selectable signature modes, each with its own welcome and goodbye anima-

tion... more content for social-media natives. Nineteen-inch wheels add to the SUV cred and the two-tone alloys are standard because there is only one trim. It's a good strategy to have just one fully loaded variant.

VINTAGE VIBES If the exterior seems evolutionary, the interior is straight up revolutionary, especially if you are

comparing it to its German trio of rivals. The dashboard and door panels are chrome- and leather-free, finished in a two-tone recycled knitted textile that the ambient lighting and the display projections play across. The 240-mm circular OLED display is the centrepiece and it is brilliant, quick and iOS-like in the way it responds. There is no driver's display at all, which takes some ad-

justment, though the standard head-up display covers most of what you need.

Despite the screen's size, the physical switches handle all the important stuff. The start button is like an old-school key (which I loved), the toggle bar below the screen handles gear selection and another toggle takes you through the eight experience modes; ‘go-kart’ is my favourite. JCW sports

seats in ‘vescin vintage brown’ are electrically adjustable with a massage function for the driver. The rear seats slide by 130 mm and recline up to 25 degrees, although space back there is not generous. The entire cabin looks designed, and not assembled, which is a win in today's world.

The 1.5-litre three-cylinder engine that powers the Countryman C is the same as the BMW X1 sDrive18i, but it makes 154 bhp and 24.5 kg-m, about 22 bhp more. It does not sound especially good; however, it is among the more refined three-cylinders around. For city driving, the power feels adequate and the 7-speed dual-clutch gearbox is smooth at low speeds. For a heavier right foot, you might miss the paddle shifters, which incidentally the X1 gets.

Ride quality is what you expect in a Mini, firm but decent. The 190 mm of ground clearance is quite useful, especially on Gurugram roads and in the rain. Barring the GLA, while driving this feels smaller than everything it competes with. It never really comes across as an SUV, but always feels like a Mini, which is a good thing.

At ₹47.5 lakh (ex-showroom), the Countryman C is not exactly an affordable fun-to-drive hatch nor is it the most engaging and powerful Mini on offer. But I don't think most prospective buyers will miss either. What the Countryman C offers instead is individuality and a view on how legacy can be modernised. If you are tired of how similar everything has become, the Countryman definitely deserves a look.

@TheMotorGram



Truck or Treat?

DUAL PURPOSE. The Toyota Hilux toys with duality, continuing with its traditional goodness while trying its hand at modernity

Ruman Devmane

Defying fan-club convention, being a die-hard Toyota loyalist is deeply rooted in objectivity. Toyota sure doesn't make the world's most beautiful cars or even the fastest or the most fun. It makes cars that last, though. Cars that are honest, brilliantly engineered and packaged with a great deal of insight. That most of them can outlive an apocalypse isn't mere folklore. The Hilux has eternally shown great promise in this regard.

Now in its ninth generation, the Hilux isn't the barebones utilitarian pickup truck it once used to be. Today, more than ever, it's what car-makers like to call a ‘lifestyle’ vehicle. That it can carry tree trunks you've chopped down yourself matters almost as much, if not more, than its ability to make the world believe you do such a thing regularly. The Hilux is no longer a mere problem solver. It's a statement. While the ‘Toyota tax’ (the premium Toyota demands, because it can) is a real thing for certain vehicles in the brand's line-up, the Hilux, for all its goodness, hasn't been able to command it. Often heavily discounted, the Hilux's future rides strongly on the success of its ninth generation. To this effect, Toyota has made a considerable effort to change what it felt it should have, while retaining a lot of the previous iteration.

For one, it looks completely different. A bit outlandish, too, especially in the photographs, but with its dimensions and resultant presence, it's still very impressive. The new 17-inch wheels look fantastic, wrapped with all-terrain tyres, and the tailgate with the classic ‘Toyota’ lettering looks very cool. There's a new side-step integrated into the rear bumper, too, for (relatively) easy access to the loading bay and, especially thanks to some brilliant colour options, you're going to

want to step into your friendly neighbourhood Toyota dealership.

FAN FAVOURITE

The interior isn't as appealing, though. Let's just say it's a cabin only the most hardcore of Toyota fans will love — and defend on the internet. Layered with purposeful grey plastics, the Hilux's cabin looks tough but lacks a sense of premiumness the Indian buyer will rightfully expect from a car of this price. While the layout is intuitive and thoughtful, and there's no dearth of physical buttons, it also feels a bit hastily configured for India. While we still get the dash-mounted cupholders (placed before the air-con vents) and a decent-sized touchscreen (simple but good UI), there are quite a few misses and compromises. The omission of automatic climate control is acceptable in my view, but its replacement — a rather shoddy bit of trim and ungainly controls — absolutely isn't. There are a few blank switches as well and even the instrument cluster is different from what is offered in other markets; it appears equally dated and austere in almost all of the three themes you can select. I do like the steering wheel a lot, though.

The fabric seats are well-designed and comfortable but aren't at all ideal for off-roading; anyone who's ever been will attest to how easy it is to stain a car's interior in such settings. Oh, and it doesn't get electric adjustability either! On balance, that's hardly any labour for someone who chops down trees for fun, right?

In any case, I was able to find a great driving position, and the outward visibility is just fantastic.

The rear seats are a far less rosy affair, though. For one, there simply isn't enough space for large-sized adults. Behind the driver's seat set to my position (I'm 6 feet tall), I could only sit with my knees digging deep into the seatback and in a somewhat knees-up stance. The backrest doesn't recline (of



TOUGH CALL. The dash layout is new but feels rugged. The fabric seats are basic but comfy, although rear-seat space isn't impressive. KAZIAD ADIL DARUKHANAWALA

course!) and, on the whole, it's a place you should best leave to kids or bags you wouldn't want to place in the loading bay. In other news, there's no sunroof (great!), the speakers do a decent-enough job, and there's a manual handbrake.

To drive, it's pleasantly familiar. At our disposal on a rainy day in Jaipur was the VX 4X4 AT, the top of three variants Toyota has offered so far, including a 4X2 as the entry-level version for the first time ever. Powering all three is the same 2.8-litre four-cylinder turbocharged diesel engine as seen in the last-gen Hilux, and that certainly isn't a bad thing. With 201.1 bhp and 51 kg-m of torque, the Hilux is sufficiently equipped to make light work of

highway drives (chopped wood in tow) and, of course, perform admirably on any sort of trail you can throw at it. The 6-speed automatic transmission works well, too, although some of you with specific driving requirements may rightfully grudge Toyota the omission of a manual-transmission option.

On the road, the Hilux continues to feel like a dominant all-conquering machine. There is some improvement to the cabin insulation levels, but the added refinement doesn't take away the feeling of driving something heavy-duty — that matters! I also think the Hilux isn't as bouncy as it felt over the course of our convoy drive because, upon inspection, I found the TPMS



BOLD STYLING. The central screen, the trim and various design choices give this Mini's interior tonnes of character. ANUBHAV SHARMA

QUICKLY.

BEML Q1 revenue rises 29%, loss narrows

Bengaluru: Defence public sector undertaking BEML Ltd reported a 29 per cent year-on-year rise in revenue from operations in Q1FY27, while its net loss narrowed sharply and operating earnings turned positive. The company's consolidated revenue from operations rose to ₹819.62 crore from ₹633.99 crore in the corresponding quarter of the previous financial year. BEML's consolidated net loss narrowed to ₹27.01 crore during the quarter from ₹64.11 crore in Q1 FY26. *ANI*

Muthoot Microfin Q1 profit rises to ₹81 crore

New Delhi: Muthoot Microfin Ltd posted a multifold jump in net profit at ₹81 crore in the first quarter ended June 2026, helped by increased loan disbursement. The non-banking financial company-micro finance institution earned a profit of ₹6 crore in the year-ago period. Total income also rose to ₹671 crore from ₹559 crore in the year-ago period. *PTI*

SBI expects \$10 b via FCNR(B) by Sept-end

GREAT INNINGS. Bank has garnered \$6 billion so far, says Setty

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The State Bank of India should be able to mobilise about \$10 billion via Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank)/FCNR (B) deposits by September-end under the RBI's limited period concessional swap facility, going by the current traction on this front, said Chairman CS Setty.

Further, the FCNR (B) deposit inflows will give India's largest bank a clear visibility on liquidity and help reduce its dependence on bulk deposits. Setty observed that while the SBI had no specific target on mobilising FCNR (B) deposits, it had garnered almost \$6 billion so far (between June 8 and till date).

GIFT CITY OPERATIONS On providing leverage support to NRI customers for placing fresh FCNR (B) deposits with the bank, the SBI



State Bank of India Chairman CS Setty *PTI*

chief said it is provided by the SBI's own branches and via its GIFT City operations.

"We have a SBLC (standby letter of credit) product also. But it is not widely used at this moment... We have raised a billion dollars via the overseas foreign currency borrowing route, but our first priority now is to fund FCNR(B) deposits," he said.

Highlighting the bank's excess liquidity, including surplus statutory liquidity ratio/SLR securities worth ₹3.09 lakh crore, Setty said that the 10-11 per cent deposit growth rate will comfortably provide the ad-

equate funding for 14-15 per cent credit growth.

He expects the surplus SLR to swell to about ₹4 lakh crore.

The SBI chief said: "I think we have mobilised a good number [FCNR (B) deposits], and we have good visibility on the mobilisation going forward... We do not foresee any interest rate change on these deposits."

Setty said that large banks, which are able to mobilise FCNR (B) deposits, will reduce their dependence on bulk/wholesale deposits on which differential interest rates are quoted by banks.

NBFC credit up 14.4% in June

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Outstanding credit extended by non-banking financial companies (NBFCs), including housing finance companies, rose 14.4 per cent year-on-year to ₹59.31 lakh crore in June 2026, reflecting sustained demand across retail, services and agriculture segments.

Retail loans remained the largest component of NBFC lending, growing 20.3 per cent to ₹25.62 lakh crore. Housing loans increased 11.4 per cent to ₹8.44 lakh crore, while vehicle loans rose 15.2 per cent to ₹6.24 lakh crore, highlighting steady consumer demand.

Interestingly, the sharpest growth continued to be seen in loans against gold jewellery, which surged 69.3 per cent year-on-year to ₹3.41 lakh crore.

Gold now accounts for 13.3 per cent of the total NBFC retail loans, nearly doubled compared to 7.7 per cent two years back in June 2024.

Meanwhile, consumer durable loans also recorded strong growth of 46.8 per cent, reaching ₹72,201 crore.

Reserve Bank rejects demerger proposal of Religare Enterprises

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India has rejected the proposed demerger scheme that sought to transfer Religare Enterprises' (REL) lending and financial services business to its subsidiary, Religare Finvest (RFL).

Under the proposed scheme of arrangement, REL was to retain its stake in Care Health Insurance and continue as an insurance-focused entity. The financial services business, comprising lending, broking, investment activities and related ancillary and support services, was proposed to be transferred to RFL on a going-concern basis.

Following the demerger, both REL and RFL were expected to be listed separately on the stock exchanges.

In February, the company's Board of Directors ap-



proved the demerger plan, and in July, it received no-objection certificates from both NSE and BSE.

Both REL and RFL had submitted applications to the RBI seeking its no-objection to the scheme.

REL said it had received a letter from the central bank, stating that the application had been examined and that the request had not been acceded to.

A similar communication was received by RFL. "REL and RFL will engage with the regulator and provide further clarifications as may be

required in this regard," the company said. As per the proposed arrangement, shareholders were to receive one share of Religare Finvest for every share held in Religare Enterprises.

Incidentally, market regulator SEBI closed its long-running investigation into the company in July, disposing of a show-cause notice issued in 2024 without imposing any penalty.

NO REASON STATED

The demerger was designed to provide Religare's lending and insurance businesses with distinct identities, allowing each entity to operate with its own listed shares and dedicated investor base.

For now, however, the restructuring plan has been put on hold until the company addresses the concerns raised by the RBI. The regulator has not disclosed the specific reasons for rejecting the proposal.

'SC judgment won't have big impact on motor third-party portfolio'

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

Shriram General Insurance does not expect the Supreme Court's judgment on compensation under the Motor Vehicles Act to have a major impact on its motor third-party portfolio.

Notably, the Supreme Court, in a recent judgment delivered on June 11, recognised the economic value of unpaid domestic work performed by homemakers while determining the compensation under the Motor Vehicles Act.

"We are analysing the impact. As we are having a large



Anil Aggarwal, MD and CEO, Shriram General Insurance Company *BUJOY GHOSH*

book, we have done the analysis. I don't think there will be much of a big impact on our books," Anil Aggarwal, MD & CEO, Shriram General

Insurance, told *businessline*.

The Supreme Court judgment provides for compensation under a distinct head — loss of domestic care — based on a monthly income of ₹30,000 with a periodic increase to reflect inflation and socio-economic changes. Motor third-party (TP) loss ratio of the general insurance industry is expected to increase due to this judgment.

MOTOR PREMIUM For Shriram General Insurance, over 90 per cent of its income, comes from the motor segment premium.

In the motor segment, around 73 per cent and 27

per cent of the premium come from TP and own damage (OD) insurance, respectively.

On the company's strategies to grow its motor segment going forward, Aggarwal said: "My strategy is not to see OD and TP separately. My strategy is always to see overall premium, whether it is profitable or not. Overall, whether OD plus TP and acquisition costs are leaving something on the table. That is the philosophy we are adopting."

In the first quarter this fiscal, its motor segment premium grew 25 per cent year-on-year, compared with industry growth of 14 per

cent y-o-y. The insurer, jointly owned by Shriram Group and Sanlam Group of South Africa, posted a 23 per cent y-o-y growth in premium income in Q1FY27, exceeding industry growth of 11 per cent y-o-y.

HEALTH INSURANCE

Aggarwal said the company is expecting its premium income to grow 20 per cent in the current financial year. The company plans to expand its distribution network by increasing the financial advisor base to 2 lakh by FY30. It is gradually strengthening its presence in the health insurance segment.

ICICI Lombard unveils motor cyber insurance for digitally connected cars

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

Your car is no longer just a machine on wheels — it is a connected digital device. From smartphones and infotainment systems to navigation and payment apps, modern vehicles are increasingly plugged into the digital ecosystem, creating vulnerabilities to cyber threats.

Addressing this emerging risk, ICICI Lombard has introduced India's first motor cyber insurance cover.

The motor cyber cover protects customers against cyber incidents affecting the insured vehicle.

"Today, our ecosystem is digitally connected, with a vast number of smartphones being used by both individuals and businesses. Vehicles, too, are increasingly connected to digital devices. Electric vehicles are inherently more software-driven, but even conventional fuel-powered cars now come



Gaurav Arora, Chief Commercial Lines & Motor (Underwriting & Claims)

equipped with advanced software and connectivity features, making them vulnerable to cyberattacks," Gaurav Arora, Chief Commercial Lines & Motor (Underwriting & Claims) told *businessline*.

WHAT'S COVERED?

The cover extends to losses resulting from hackers gaining access to financial data or digital assets through a connected vehicle. It also provides protection against incidents such as cyber-enabled vehicle immobilisation or lockouts, where attackers

demand a ransom to restore access, as well as damage to vehicle software caused by hacking.

"We saw a clear need to address this emerging risk and developed what we believe is an industry-first motor cyber insurance cover for customers using connected vehicles. The cover will be available as an optional rider for policyholders who wish to opt for it," said Arora.

The motor cyber cover covers risks such as unauthorised access, hacking, digital compromise, cyber extortion, theft of funds and legal liabilities arising from cyber attacks through the vehicle and its connected devices.

The cover also pays for restoring the access and reinstallation of software affected due to cyber incidents. Additionally, it also covers indemnification for direct financial loss arising out of unauthorised access of digital wallets.

Our Bureau
Kolkata

The Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) expects assets under management (AUM) of the national pension system (NPS) to grow to around ₹40 lakh crore in the next four years, from around ₹18 lakh crore at present, driven by the addition of at least two to three crore new subscribers from the non-government sector annually.

Currently, around 15 per cent of the AUM of NPS comes from the non-government sector.

SUBSCRIBER BASE

Total subscribers of NPS, a defined contribution pension system, from the non-government sector stands at around 90 lakh at present.

"With the new digital platforms coming in, we are hoping to see at least two to three crore new subscribers

coming in annually. In the first year it may not be so much, but in a full year, say if we take the next year, the full year, we should certainly hope to get two to three crore," PFRDA Chairperson S Ramann told mediapersons in Kolkata on Friday.

NETWORKING EVENT

PFRDA organised an outreach event for mutual fund distributors on Star NPS and NPS in the city.

"We are especially inviting mutual fund distributors to come on to Star NPS. They are already familiar with BSE STAR MF. We are now advising the mutual fund distributors to bring in their customers into NPS as well. Mutual funds today have a holding period of average two-and-a-half years. But, NPS is that account where you cannot take your money out... If you don't keep your money for 15 years, you would never see the growth of the money," said Ramann.

UPI services to be free for consumers

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Consumers and small merchants will continue to enjoy free Unified Payments Interface (UPI) services even as the Lok Sabha passed a Bill to amend the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, the Payments Council of India said on Friday.

In a post on X, the association said: "UPI has always been free for consumers since its launch in 2016. Every Indian can continue making instant digital payments without paying any transaction charges."

The Payments Council of India said small merchants, including kirana stores, will also continue to accept UPI payments without paying the merchant discount rate.

As aviation demand surges, Safran explores expanding India presence beyond engines

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

French aerospace major Safran is exploring opportunities to expand its presence in India beyond aircraft engines as the country's rapidly growing aviation market creates demand across multiple segments of the aerospace ecosystem.

'INDIA, KEY PRIORITY'

Speaking to *businessline*, Safran India CEO and Country Head JS Gavankar said India's aviation growth story has made the market a strategic priority for the company across its business verticals, including propulsion, equipment and interiors.

"India's aviation growth story is compelling enough to attract every division of

Safran," Gavankar added. The company's comments come at a time when Indian airlines have placed aircraft orders exceeding 2,000 planes, creating long-term demand for aeroengine, aviation components, cabin solutions and maintenance services.

At present, Safran has operations in India focused on areas that include aircraft engines and aerospace equipment, but the company sees potential for deeper engagement across the aviation value chain.

"With Indian carriers having ordered over 2,000 aircraft and a rapidly growing passenger base, the demand pull for aviation interior solutions, including MRO, is enormous," said Gavankar.

The company, however, did not disclose any specific



timeline or investment plan for the future in India.

The expansion of aircraft manufacturing and services capabilities has become a key focus area for India as the country seeks to increase domestic value addition in aviation.

Besides aircraft operations, the growth of airlines is expected to create demand for aircraft interiors, seating

systems, cabin equipment and other aviation-related products. Safran's India revenue is targeted to increase multifold over the coming years, with deeper participation across multiple business lines expected to support this growth.

"Safran will triple its revenue to exceed €3 billion by 2030, of which half will be generated by our sites in India. In the near future, Safran will double its supplier network as part of its plan to expand the supplier ecosystem in India," he said.

SOURCING ACTIVITY

Furthermore, Safran has announced plans to multiply sourcing activity from India by five times by 2030 as Indian aerospace suppliers become integrated into its global supply chain.



KSE
L I M I T E D
ISO 9001 : 2015 COMPANY
CIN No: L15331KL1963PLC002028

Regd. Office: Post Box No. 20,
Solvent Road, Irinjalakuda, Kerala - 680 121
Ph: 0480 2825476, 2825576, 2826075, 2826676
Email: ksekerala@gmail.com, investor.relations@kselimited.com
Web: www.kselimited.com

62ND ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND BOOK CLOSURE
(Notice pursuant to Section 91 and 108 of the Companies Act, 2013)
Notice is hereby given that:
1. The 62nd Annual General Meeting of the Company ("AGM") will be convened on Saturday, 29th August, 2026 at 3.00 p.m. IST at the Registered Office of the Company, at Solvent Road, Irinjalakuda - 680 121, Thrissur District, Kerala to transact the business as set out in the Notice of AGM.
2. In terms of MCA Circulars and SEBI Circulars, the Notice of the 62nd AGM and the Annual Report for the financial year 2025-2026 including the Audited Financial Statements for the year ended 31st March, 2026 ("Annual Report") have been sent by email to those Members whose email addresses are registered with the Company / Depository Participants. The requirement of sending physical copy of the Notice of the 62nd AGM and Annual Report to the Members has been dispensed with vide MCA Circular/s and SEBI Circular. Additionally, in accordance with Regulation 36(1)(b) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (Listing Regulations), the Company is also sending a letter to shareholders, whose e-mail IDs are not registered with Company/RTA/DP, providing the weblink of Company's website from where the Annual Report for financial year 2025-26 can be accessed.
3. Pursuant to Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Rule 20 of Companies (Management and Administration) Rules 2014 and Regulation 44 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the Company has made necessary arrangements with Central Depository Services Limited (CDSL) to facilitate the remote electronic voting in respect of the businesses set out in the notice convening the 62nd Annual General Meeting of the Company. The dispatch details of the Notice (by email as mentioned above) as well as the details of remote e-voting are as under:

Date of completion of dispatch of notice of AGM and Annual Report 2025-2026 (by email as mentioned above)		07.08.2026
Cut-off/Record date for ascertaining eligible shareholders for voting		21 st August, 2026
Date and Time for remote voting through electronic means	Commencement	Wednesday, 26 th August, 2026, 09:00 hrs. (IST)
	Ending	Friday, 28 th August, 2026, 17.00 hrs. (IST)

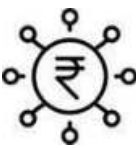
| 4. Members may please note that (i) remote electronic voting would not be allowed beyond the aforesaid date and time limits; (ii) any member of the Company, who has become a member of the Company after the despatch of Notice but before the cut-off date may obtain their User ID and Password for Remote E-voting from the Registrars and Share Transfer Agents of the Company; (iii) the remote e-Voting module shall be disabled by CDSL after the aforesaid date and time for voting and once the vote on a resolution is cast by the Member, the Member shall not be allowed to change it subsequently; (iv) Members who have cast their vote by remote e-Voting prior to the 62nd AGM may participate in the 62nd AGM but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again during the 62nd AGM; (v) the Members participating in the 62nd AGM and who had not cast their vote by remote e-Voting, shall be entitled to cast their vote during the 62nd AGM; and (vi) a person whose name is recorded in the Register of Members or in the Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by the depositories as on the cut-off date only shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-Voting, participate in the 62nd AGM and e-voting during the 62nd AGM. 5. Those Members holding shares in physical form, whose email addresses are not registered with the Company, may register their email address, by sending the scanned copy of a signed request letter mentioning name, folio number and complete address, self-attested scanned copy of the PAN Card; and self-attested scanned copy of any document (such as AADHAR Card, Driving Licence, Election Identity Card, Passport) in support of the address of the Member as registered with the Company, by email to coimbatore@in.mrms.mufg.com. Members holding shares in demat form can update their email address with their Depository Participant. 6. A member entitled to attend and vote at the meeting is entitled to appoint a proxy to attend and vote instead of himself/herself and proxy need not be member of the company. The instrument appointing proxy to be valid should be deposited at the Registered Office of the Company not less than 48 hours before the commencement of the meeting. 7. The Company has appointed CS Nikhil George Pinto or failing him, CS Tracy Caesar, Partners of M/s. CaesarPintoJohn & Associates LLP, Practicing Company Secretaries, to act as the Scrutinizer, to scrutinise the entire e-voting process in a fair and transparent manner. 8. The full text of the Notice of AGM and Explanatory Statement has been hosted on the website of the company (www.kselimited.com) and on the website of CDSL (www.cdslindia.com). 9. Any person who is not a shareholder / ceased to be a shareholder as on the cut-off date should treat this notice for information purpose only. Notice is further given pursuant to Section 91 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Rule 10 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 and also Regulation 42 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 that the Register of Members and the Share Transfer Books of the Company will remain closed from 23 August 2026 to 29th August, 2026 (both days inclusive) for the purpose of determination of members who are entitled to receive the final dividend, if declared in the AGM. Members who have any grievances pertaining to remote e-voting may contact Mr. Jayakumar K., Manager (Systems and Support), M/s. MUFG Intime India Private Limited, Registrars and Share Transfer Agents, "Surya", 35, Mayflower Avenue, Behind Senthil Nagar, Sowripalayam Road, Coimbatore - 641028, Phone : 0422 4958995, 2539835, 2539836; Email: coimbatore@in.mrms.mufg.com. | | |

| By Order of the Board For **KSE LIMITED** Sd/- **Srividya Damodaran** Company Secretary | | |
| Place : Irinjalakuda Date : 07-08-2026 | | |

Timely support

MSME Act amendments can aid timely payments

The recently tabled Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (Amendment) Bill, 2026, can enhance the flow of timely payments to MSMEs. The proposed amendments should be seen as part of a slew of recent steps to ensure that Section 15 of the MSME Act, 2006 — which says that MSME suppliers’ dues should be settled in 45 days — is implemented.



It has not been easy to make this provision work. MSMEs do not proceed against large buyers — by moving the Micro and Small Enterprise Facilitation Councils (MSEFCs) set up in States or other debt recovery forums — for fear of losing business. Their working capital flows are hurt in the process. However, the Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS), ushered in by the Reserve Bank of India in 2014, has led to an improvement in the delayed payments scenario. The recent amendments are aimed at improving the effectiveness of TReDS and MSEFCs. Under TReDS, a digital marketplace for bills discounting, MSMEs raise their respective invoices on registered buyers, which approve the same; thereafter, these invoices are placed in the public domain for financiers to pay the seller (after offering competitive discounts) in one or two days. The seller benefits hugely from easy recovery at reasonable cost, with the crucial benefit of not being asked upon to pay if the buyer defaults.

Yet, TReDS’ growth remains hamstrung by buyers’ reluctance to onboard the platform — fearing financial scrutiny and loss of confidentiality. Industry data and research show that while number of sellers registered on TReDS is in the region of 1.5 lakh, buyers (with a turnover of over ₹250 crore) are barely about 10,000. It is another matter that the proportion of MSMES on TReDS is under 0.5 per cent of about seven crore MSMEs. MSMEs on the platform have reported a 23-40 per cent fall in payment timelines, and a rise in their profitability — yet their membership has not risen exponentially. Indeed, TReDS’ effectiveness depends on the number of participants.

The amendment now mandates that central PSUs use TReDS alone to pay MSMEs. This can have a demonstration effect. For other buyers, it is crucial that the benefits of staying outside TReDS should recede. Tax breaks for onboarding, and lowering the turnover threshold can help here. The difficulties faced by MSMEs, specially the smaller ones, in onboarding TReDS need to be addressed. They are left to deal with cumbersome recovery systems — such as MSEFCs, which are mediation bodies, and debt recovery systems such as IBC for claims above ₹1 crore. Under the amendment, MSEFCs must adhere to timelines. If mediation does not work within 90 days, the Councils get another 120 days to conclude arbitration. What is important is that the cost of challenging the Councils’ award in court has been raised. Buyers may have to cough up a large proportion of the disputed sum upfront. Large buyers should be persuaded (through steps such as Section 43 B(h) of the Income Tax Act) not to regard delayed payments as a source of finance.

POCKET

RAVIKANTH



RAJIB DASGUPTA

The National Eligibility cum Entrance Test – Under Graduate (NEET-UG) has been in the eye of a storm over paper leaks. A high-level committee has been set up to probe the issue and suggest remedial steps. Parliament has passed an amendment to the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024, which stipulates fast track trials and a longer prison term.

However, it is important to situate the debate on reforming medical education in the broader context. There is a supply side (of candidates) and a demand side (the health profile of the population) to the NEET issue. The first is linked to the commercialisation of medical education. This article explores these two dimensions.

To begin with, the NEET-UG is a national level qualifying examination for admission to undergraduate medical, dental, AYUSH programmes with two million or more candidates competing each year. The competition and anxieties are largely around the admission to the MBBS programme, in 450 government and 373 private or trust-managed colleges with a capacity of 129,602 seats and regulated by the National Medical Commission (NMC). The medical colleges of southern and western States have about half the capacity and Uttar Pradesh is among the less-developed States with a large proportion in seats.

NEET-UG is the single largest undergraduate level entrance examination in the country; the success rate for an admission to a medical college is about 4-5 per cent and less than 2 per cent for government colleges. Further, those planning to pursue an MBBS degree abroad (most of them in central and east Asia) need to clear NEET-UG. What fuels the demand for this?

CORPORATE HEALTHCARE

One of the factors, besides livelihood concerns, is the revenue and EBITDA growth across major corporate hospital operators — upwards of 15 per cent year-on-year driven by high-acuity specialities such as cardiology and oncology. EBITDA margins being in the diagnostics sector is more than 25 per cent currently. Hospital sector mainboard IPOs in India over the last three years have ranged from about ₹ 1 to 10 billion.

The number of doctors is growing currently more rapidly than ever before, fuelled by the lure of corporate medicine. Yet, notwithstanding the policy emphasis on Sustainable



KARUNAKARAN M

NEET and pain points in medical education

HEALTH STATUS. The system should be equipped to provide comprehensive primary healthcare and bridge the gap between private and public care models

Development Goals (SDGs) in general and Universal Health Coverage (UHC), shortage of specialist doctors at community health centres (CHCs) in rural areas has remained fairly constant at 70-80 per cent.

PUBLIC HEALTHCARE

What is less recognised here is the role that Centre and States have played in improving decentralised healthcare and creating more doctors and colleges to this end. There has been a significant closing of shortfalls in the primary health centres (PHCs). Alongside, there has been a rapid doubling of colleges and capacities in the last 12 years with the number of medical colleges up from 387 in 2014 to 844 with a corresponding increase in undergraduate MBBS seats from 51,348 to 139,489. Interestingly, while the number of government

colleges exceeded private colleges, 441 vs 382, the capacity was more in the private colleges (73,643 vs 63,296). (see box)

Therefore, while the NEET exam attracts a large number of aspirants for a number of reasons, it would be inaccurate to assume that the number of seats has not increased, or that hospital infrastructure has remained unchanged. The problem, in fact, lies in the quality side. While both Union and State governments have focused on accelerating numbers of medical graduates and post-graduates, harnessing numbers and skills in public health service continues to be a challenge. Major shortcomings in the quality of medical education include poor pedagogy, low student-teacher ratios, absence of faculty appraisals and subpar faculty competence. This is even

as rural health challenges remain serious.

An epidemiological transition implies long-term shifts in health and disease patterns and Epidemiological Transition Ratio (ETR) is used to calculate its status. A high ETR implies a higher burden of communicable diseases and maternal and nutritional conditions compared to chronic diseases. Recent analyses indicate that the ETR value for India is around 36, meaning for every 100 disability-adjusted life-years (DALYs) lost to non-communicable diseases, there are 36 DALYs lost to infectious, nutritional, maternal, and perinatal diseases.

The top-three States with high ETRs are: Uttar Pradesh at 90 (male, 79 and female, 101), Madhya Pradesh at 69 (male, 71 and female, 67) and Rajasthan also at 69 (male, 64 and female, 74) implying a significant dual burden, especially among females. Kerala has the lowest ETR at seven (male, nine and female, five) followed by Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Maharashtra, Himachal Pradesh and Telangana, indicating a predominant burden of NCDs.

This calls for a meaningful strengthening of comprehensive primary healthcare at the frontlines and greater synergy with medical colleges to support the frontline actors and activities. This is the larger context in which the medical education system and its objectives needs to be viewed.

The writer is Professor at the Centre of Social Medicine and Community Health, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi and Former Editor, Indian Journal of Public Health

Govt push and limitations

Much of the recent push to create capacity has come through a centrally sponsored scheme — Establishment of New Medical Colleges Attached to District Hospitals and the One District One Medical College. This is geared towards setting up new colleges in remote and underserved areas by upgradation of a district hospital where there were no prior government or private medical colleges. The union government is providing a 90:10 support for North-Eastern and special category States and 60:40 for others.

A key arm of this new initiative is the

District Residency Programme — a three-months compulsory rural posting of postgraduates to strengthen both services and training.

Research studies drawing upon real-world experience and perceptions of postgraduates across diverse States such as Himachal Pradesh, Rajasthan, Telangana and Tamil Nadu point to a set of synergistic findings: Less than half of respondents perceiving that the objectives were met; limited clinical exposure and training; and frustration with resource limitations. This needs priority attention.

The MPC’s August tightrope and the road ahead

Given that consumption drives a large share of the economy, growth prospects now hinge on investment and productivity

RK Pattnaik

The Monetary Policy Committee’s (MPC) move to keep the repo rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent was driven by the uncertainties emerging from the West Asian conflict and the El Nino factor.

INFLATION PATH

The MPC’s August 5 resolution trimmed the inflation forecast marginally, by 0.1 percentage point, to 5 per cent, while revising the growth forecast upward by 0.1 percentage point to 6.7 per cent for FY2026-27, compared with the forecast set out on June 5, 2026.

This divergence from the June forecast largely reflects a rebalancing of risks to growth and inflation stemming from external shocks, weighed against the resilience of domestic factors. Under the FIT framework, the headline Consumer Price Index-Combined (CPI-C) — comprising food, fuel, and services inflation — remains the official measure of inflation.

One issue worth flagging is the change in weights following the shift to the 2024-25 base year, from the earlier 2012 base year, which gives lower weightage to food and beverages and a higher one to services.

Although core inflation (headline

inflation minus food and fuel) is not the official FIT metric, the increased weight assigned to services warrants closer scrutiny, since it now carries greater influence over the headline number. The Governor’s statement pegged core inflation at 4.3 per cent.

Beyond the core inflation estimate and the higher weight now given to services, the volatility in fuel prices — driven by geopolitical developments — remains a concern, given its potential to adversely affect the medium-term outlook for headline CPI inflation.

INVESTMENT PUSH

Turning to medium-term growth, given that consumption already drives a large share of the economy, growth prospects now hinge on investment — both domestic and foreign.

It is expected that robust growth in non-food credit, at 17.7 per cent in July 15, 2026 which is broad-based across sectors, could translate into higher private investment.

For growth to be higher and more sustainable, private investment needs to lead rather than follow. This is where productivity, rather than mere production, becomes critical. Strengthening total factor productivity, along with capital and labour productivity, will help foster durable growth.



MPC. Challenging times

However, this is easier said than done given ecosystem challenges and the friction surrounding structural reforms.

Transmission of monetary policy through the interest rate channel also deserves careful attention. The weighted average call rate (WACR) at 5.31 per cent during June 6 to July 31 2026 — the operating target of monetary policy — only six points higher than policy repo rate has moved broadly in sync with the repo within the Liquidity Adjustment Facility (LAF) corridor.

On the deposit side, the weighted average domestic term deposit rate (WADTDR) on fresh deposits has declined by 63 bps while that on outstanding deposits has softened by 51 bps during the same period. This shows that the monetary policy transmission has been incomplete. For the transmission to be effective, both short-

and long-term rates need to respond positively to the WACR, translating into appropriate adjustments in bank lending and deposit rates.

On the external front, a sustainable current account deficit in the medium term would be in the range of 2.5 to 3 per cent of GDP, alongside a growth rate of around 7 per cent — and this gap should ideally be financed more through FDI than through debt.

Measures to encourage inflows into FCNR(B) deposits, which have drawn around \$36.7 billion, have helped curb rupee volatility to some extent initially, though they may eventually add to the external debt burden.

The prospect is of a weaker currency and higher external debt.

It is true that managing monetary policy has grown more difficult, as balancing growth and inflation dynamics is compounded by unprecedented geopolitical tensions and uncertainty over monsoon and climate conditions — a daunting task. What is needed going forward is a shift from consumption-led growth toward investment-led growth, with private investment playing the lead role.

The writer is Professor at the Gokhale Institute of Politics & Economics, Pune, and a former central banker. Views expressed are personal (Through The Billion Press)

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Pragmatic move

The Supreme Court’s proposal to link vehicle insurance verification with petrol pumps is a pragmatic step towards road safety and financial accountability. Beyond protecting accident victims mandatory third-party insurance is vital for the general insurance sector. Automating checks at fuel stations leverages digital infrastructure creating operational synergies for InsurTech and Oil Marketing Companies. However success hinges on resolving data privacy and operational challenges. Balanced with affordable premiums, this tech-driven enforcement will de-risk motor

insurance portfolios while fostering responsible vehicle ownership.
AC Vineeth Kumar
Thrissur

UPI levy

Apropos the Editorial ‘No free rides’ (August 7), the edit has argued in favour of a small levy on each transaction; some favour a small MDR, others say it could be above a transaction value. None of these discusses the savings that accrue as cash is being replaced by UPI. Firstly currency printing costs would be down. Some argue that the currency in circulation has remained steady despite UPI. That’s not the right way to look at it. We must see

how much more currency would have been in circulation in the absence of UPI. Then there is the cost of idle cash in bank branches, homes, in ATMs, etc., the staff cost of banks’ tellers, the capital and operational costs of ATMs. All savings could fund the cost of UPI.
V Vijaykumar
Pune

Sensible step

Apropos ‘No free rides’ (August 7), introducing a small charge on larger digital payments is a sensible step toward keeping our financial networks running smoothly. While free transactions helped millions adopt digital payments, maintaining

secure and reliable systems costs money. By keeping daily micro-payments free, everyday consumers and small vendor livelihoods stay protected. However, timing is vital. Introducing fees too soon might discourage people from using digital tools just as the habit takes root. A gradual, fair approach will preserve public confidence while building a sustainable digital economy that benefits everyone.
K Chidanand Kumar
Bengaluru

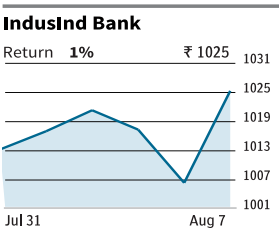
UPI infrastructure

The proposal to introduce MDR (Merchant Discount Rate) on UPI

transactions is welcome considering the need to maintain and invest further on the tech infrastructure of UPI. It is also already clarified that the end customers will not be charged and it will be only collected from Merchants. Even after the introduction of MDR, there may be need for government support and budget allocation. It is important that such levy or discount is not collected from small vendors.. Also, the merchants should not pass it on to customers indirectly by marking up prices.
Kasiraman Ramachandran
New Jersey, USA

QUICKLY.

IndusInd Bank gets RBI nod for stock broking arm



Chennai: IndusInd Bank on Friday informed the exchanges that it has received approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to set up a wholly owned subsidiary for undertaking stock broking business. The bank has also been permitted to infuse equity capital into the new subsidiary, subject to additional conditions mentioned in the RBI letter, the release added. This new entity will be dedicated to undertaking stockbroking business, marking a significant strategic expansion for the Bank. Shares of IndusInd Bank closed 1.9 per cent higher at ₹1,025 on the BSE. OUR BUREAU

Chavda Infra shareholders approve 1:1 bonus issue

Mumbai: Chavda Infra has received shareholders approval through a postal ballot for an issuance of 1:1 bonus. The approval underscores the company's continued commitment to enhance shareholder value while reflecting confidence in its long-term growth strategy and strong business fundamentals. The Board of Directors also approved an increase in the company's authorised share capital from ₹35 crore to ₹70 crore, subject to shareholders' approval, to support the bonus issue and provide greater financial flexibility for future growth initiatives. The Board further decided to retain earnings to strengthen the company's financial position, reinforcing its focus on supporting business expansion and creating sustainable long-term value for all stakeholders. OUR BUREAU

BROKER'S CALL.

Prabhudas Lilladhar

ASTER DM HEALTHCARE (BUY)

Target: ₹920
CMP: ₹870.30
Aster DM Healthcare's Q1 consolidated EBITDA grew 28 per cent year on year to ₹270 crore, 8 per cent above our estimates, aided by strong performance across clusters. During the quarter, newly-commercialised greenfield unit in Kasargod reported EBITDA breakeven vs loss of ₹8 crore in Q4FY26. The Quality Care (QCIL) ramp-up has been on track with 32 per cent EBITDA growth for Q1. Aster completed its merger with QCIL, effective Q2FY27, making it the third-largest healthcare chain by revenue and bed capacity in India. Aster's consolidated revenue improved 22 per cent to ₹1,310 crore; 6 per cent above our estimates. Occupancy improved 300 bps to 62 per cent led by higher IP volume growth. Total patients' volumes increased 16 per cent to 1.03 million. ALOS improved 4 per cent to 3 days. Net cash stood at ₹510 crore, as of Q1FY27. For combined entity, net debt stood at ₹1,160 crore. We remain positive on Aster given the rising visibility on post-merger synergies, occupancy improvement, margin expansion and upcoming bed additions. Our FY27E and FY28E EBITDA stands increased 3-5 per cent for the combined entity. We estimate combined entity post-Ind As EBITDA to grow at 24 per cent+ CAGR over FY26-28E to ₹3,100 crore. The combined entity is trading at 30x EV/EBITDA on FY28E (adjusted for minority stake and rental). We maintain our 'Buy' rating with revised TP of ₹920, valuing 32x EV/EBITDA for the combined entity on FY28E.

InCred Equities

TIMKEN INDIA (ADD)

Target: ₹3,812
CMP: ₹3,357.65
Timken India's Q1FY27 EBITDA rose 21 per cent year on year at ₹170 crore, 5 per cent above our estimate and 3 per cent above Bloomberg (BB) consensus estimate. Sales were up 15 per cent at ₹930 crore, in line with our/BB consensus estimates. The EBITDA margin rose 94 bp to 18.5 per cent on lower raw material costs. Bharuch plant ramp-up remains ahead of expectations, with ₹50-crore revenue in Q1-FY27. SRB (Spherical Roller Bearing) capacity utilisation is expected to reach 70 per cent by August-September 2026F. Rail component expansion project at Jamshedpur is expected to start commercial production by CY26F-end. FY27F capex guidance at 8-10 per cent of sales remains unchanged. Exports (+21 per cent), strong demand from the US market, particularly for taper bearings, offset the weakness in Europe, China and ASEAN region. Considering that the new Bharuch plant will support sustained double-digit export growth, we have raised our FY27F-29F revenue estimates by 1 per cent. The company's ability to pass on elevated input costs and preserve gross margin led us to increase our EBITDA estimates by 2 per cent in Q1FY27-29F. Consequently, we have increased our PAT estimates by 2 per cent for the same period. Backed by strong execution and sustained double-digit growth, we upgrade Timken India's rating to ADD (from HOLD), valuing the stock at 45x one-year forward P/E, in line with its seven-year average forward multiple, and arrive at a higher target price of ₹3,812 (₹3,637 earlier).

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RBI's draft lending norms weaken NBFC stocks, drag Sensex, Nifty

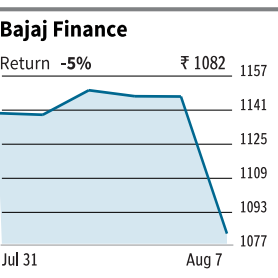
IMPACT ON STREET. Bajaj Finance, Bajaj Finserv fall as central bank's proposal will restrict their revolving credit

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

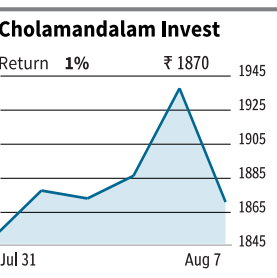
The Reserve Bank of India's draft proposal to restrict revolving credit facilities for non-banking financial companies sent shock waves through the financial sector on Friday, pulling benchmarks lower even as strong corporate earnings from SBI, Motherson Sumi and Hindalco kept the broader market relatively steady. Bajaj Finance plunged nearly 6 per cent, the steepest fall among Nifty 50 constituents, after the RBI's draft Credit Facilities Directions proposed that most NBFCs be limited primarily to term loans, effectively curtailing flexi-loan and over-

draft-style products that have become central to their business models. Bajaj Finserv shed 3.7 per cent, Cholamandalam Investment 3.8 per cent, and selling pressure spread across the broader NBFC space. RBI has invited stakeholder comments until August 28, leaving room for modifications before the framework is finalised. Nifty Financial Services index slipped 1.48 per cent. The Nifty 50 closed at 24,570, down 0.27 per cent, while the Sensex fell 456 points or 0.58 per cent to settle at 78,499.

WEEKLY GOOD SHOW
Despite Friday's decline, both indices ended the week in positive territory, with the



Nifty gaining 0.77 per cent. PSU Banks and Defence were the standout sectoral performers for the week, rising 5 per cent and 4 per cent respectively. "The market's concern is that a structural change in lending practices could alter the growth trajectory of retail-focused NBFCs over the medium term," said Hariselman Radhakrishnan of



HST Wealth, adding that the immediate reaction reflected uncertainty rather than any reassessment of underlying asset quality.

EARNINGS SUPPORT
The day's losses were cushioned by gains in Auto and IT stocks. State Bank of India rose nearly 4 per cent after reporting a 10 per cent jump in net profit for the June

quarter, with gross NPAs declining to 1.47 per cent, its best asset quality reading in years. Motherson Sumi surged 8.7 per cent after doubling its quarterly profit and posting record revenue. Hindalco gained 3 per cent on the back of a 32 per cent y-o-y rise in quarterly revenue. The broader markets held up better than the headline indices. The Nifty Midcap 100 edged up 0.22 per cent, while the Nifty Smallcap 100 ended nearly flat, with both indices hovering near all-time highs. Looking ahead, the markets are expected to trade with a positive bias next week, supported by resilient domestic fundamentals and the final stretch of the Q1FY27 earnings season.

Jefferies cuts HDFC Bank, PB Fintech

Reuters

India's outlook is strengthening as bank credit growth reaches its fastest pace in more than a decade, FPI inflows return and RBI measures support the rupee, according to Jefferies. "There are some positives to be aware of as regards the Indian domestic story," Christopher Wood, Jefferies' global head of equity strategy, said. MCX and Lenskart will replace HDFC Bank and PB Fintech in its India long-only portfolio. REC makes way for Bajaj Finance. Eternal's weight would rise, and Bharti Airtel would see a cut.



Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India has revamped its inspection framework for market intermediaries, reducing the number of routine inspections while shifting to a more risk-based and co-ordinated supervisory approach from FY27. The changes are aimed at strengthening regulatory oversight while improving ease of doing business for intermediaries. "The regulatory oversight of market intermediaries has been strengthened by employing a dynamic approach to encompass new risk para-

meters for identifying and shortlisting of entities for inspections," SEBI said. Further, it adopted the enhanced inspection framework after discussions with market infrastructure institutions (MIIs) and the supervisory body for investment advisers and research analysts. Under the revised approach, inspections of stock

brokers and depository participants will be conducted jointly by stock exchanges and depositories. **FEWER INSPECTIONS** Among the key changes, SEBI reduced the targeted number of inspections for FY27 to about one-third of those undertaken in the previous financial year, noting that stock exchanges and depositories already conduct regular inspections of stock brokers, depository participants, investment advisers and research analysts. The regulator will also discontinue repetitive annual comprehensive inspections of compliant entities, particularly stock

brokers. Instead, it will focus on entities that consistently appear in risk-based shortlisting, have high risk scores, or trigger multiple alerts from exchanges. SEBI also increased the weight assigned to exchange-generated alerts, investor complaints and social media inputs while selecting entities for inspection. Shortlisting will now be undertaken every quarter. In addition, inspections may be initiated based on market intelligence and references received from SEBI's regional and local offices, covering issues such as technical glitches, cyber incidents, and authorised persons of stockbrokers.

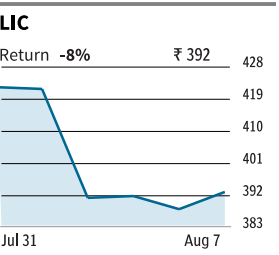
LIC gains 1.7% as brokerages upgrade targets after VNB margin beat in Q1

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Shares of the Life Insurance Corporation of India closed at ₹394 on the NSE on Friday, up 1.66 per cent from Thursday's close of ₹387.55, with volumes crossing 363 lakh shares.

The stock touched an intra-day high of ₹396.85, extending gains after the state-owned insurer posted its Q1-FY27 results on Thursday, which showed a sharp improvement in profitability metrics.

BROKERAGE UPGRADES Motilal Oswal reiterated a 'Buy' with a revised target of ₹480, citing 730 basis points of year-on-year expansion in Value of New Business margin to 22.9 per cent in Q1-FY27. The brokerage raised its VNB margin estimates for FY27 and FY28 and expects operating Return on Embedded Value in the range of 11.5-12 per cent. Jefferies, which raised its target to ₹530, described the VNB as a roughly 30 per cent



beat over its estimate and consensus, noting that LIC had narrowed the margin gap with private sector peers to 200-300 basis points. JM Financial maintained 'Buy' at ₹480, attributing the margin expansion to product mix benefits of about 650 basis points and assumption changes of about 290 basis points, partially offset by approximately 190 basis points of expense drag including a loss of GST input tax credit. Macquarie kept an 'Outperform' rating with a ₹550 target, pointing to the recent government stake sale of 6.5 per cent removing a key stock overhang and calling the current valuation of 0.5 times FY27 Price to Embedded Value attractive.

Trent falls 3.5% post results, analysts divided on outlook

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Shares of Trent Ltd closed sharply lower on Friday, ending the session at ₹2,997 on the NSE, down 3.54 per cent from Thursday's close of ₹3,107.10. The stock's decline came a day after Trent posted Q1FY27 stand-alone results that beat analyst estimates on most metrics. Revenue rose 18.5 per cent year-on-year to ₹5,666 crore and PAT grew 26 per cent to ₹532 crore. Gross margins came in at 46.6 per cent, up 149 basis points year-on-year, surprising most brokerages on the upside. Analyst reactions were broadly positive but divided on valuation. Morgan Stanley maintained 'Overweight' and raised its target to

₹3,406. Motilal Oswal and Axis Direct both reiterated 'Buy' with targets of ₹3,775 and ₹3,640 respectively, citing strong margin execution and store expansion. Macquarie (Outperform, ₹3,600) and Bernstein (Outperform, ₹3,500) also saw Q1 as a beat, with Macquarie attributing the gross margin strength to a rising share of Westside, which carries higher margins. However, Jefferies maintained 'Hold' with a revised target of ₹3,435, noting that like-for-like growth remained muted in the low single digits, partly due to store densification. Citi held its 'Sell' rating with a target of ₹2,950, arguing that while margins had surprised, an acceleration in revenue growth is needed to justify current valuation multiples.

Ardee Industries IPO subscription hits over 133 times, led by NIIs, QIBs demand

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Ardee Industries' IPO has attracted strong response from investors, drawing 133.66 times overall subscription. The qualified institutional buyers portion was subscribed 197.77 times, while non-institutional investors category saw subscription of 255.24 times. The retail investor portion was subscribed 45.71 times.

BEATS PEERS

Its 133.66 times subscription exceeds CMR Green Technologies at 127.07x, Gravita India at 42.88x and Jain Resource Recycling at 16.76x, making it the highest overall subscribed IPO among the sector comparables.

IPO participation	
	No. of times
QIBs	197.77
Non-institutions	255.24
Retail investors	45.71
Total	133.66

The company launched its ₹426-crore initial public offering at a price band of ₹50-53 per share. The IPO comprised a fresh issue of ₹320 crore and an offer-for-sale of up to 1.99 crore shares by promoters. Of the proceeds from the fresh issue, ₹220 crore will be used to fund the company's incremental working capital requirements, ₹22 crore will be allocated towards debt repayment, and the remaining amount will be used for general corporate purposes.

NSE moots tighter oversight of authorised persons, stricter eligibility norms

curity deposit of ₹1 lakh with the stockbroker.

DIGITAL FOOTPRINTS

APs would be required to disclose their bank and demat accounts, authorise brokers to access these records and provide details of websites and social media accounts used for client acquisition or capital markets-related posts. Brokers would be required to screen these digital footprints and retain evidence of such checks. The exchanges have invited public comments on the proposals until August 27. "The stock broker shall be responsible for all acts of omission and commission of its APs and/or their employees and shall be liable for all consequences, obligations, and liabilities arising therefrom." It also mandates surprise audits, off-site surveillance alerts, annual compliance training, client verification calls and publication of complaint data relating to APs.

Nifty 50 Movers					▼ 65.35 pts.
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN%	
M&M	3502.00	18.73	21.51	2.78	
TCS	2452.70	17.78	17.73	2.23	
Reliance Ind	1334.80	14.47	20.49	8.03	
State Bank	1097.20	11.02	11.69	4.03	
Hindalco	1099.60	10.31	17.78	1.36	
Grossm Ind	3233.00	8.49	21.95	1.12	
Bharti Airtel	1959.90	7.91	32.80	5.30	
Infosys	1175.10	7.74	15.72	3.67	
HCL Tech	1356.60	4.98	21.12	1.27	
Hind Unilever	2096.00	3.20	46.93	1.65	
Eicher Motors	8020.00	1.58	38.14	0.96	
Bharat Elec	401.00	1.41	47.68	1.28	
Bajaj Auto	11662.00	1.02	28.21	1.15	
ONGC	238.85	0.89	6.71	0.83	
PowerGrid Corp	271.60	0.84	15.86	1.09	
Wipro	187.53	0.83	13.98	0.45	
NestleIndia	1540.00	0.78	77.92	0.98	
UltraTech Cement	12105.00	0.78	41.62	1.27	
Tata Motors PV	347.00	0.75	4259.81	0.64	
Int'lGlobeAvi	5333.00	0.72	0.00	1.07	
ITC	286.10	0.42	17.76	2.45	
Tech Mahindra	1655.00	0.39	31.04	0.92	
Dr Reddy's Lab	1172.00	0.31	30.78	1.44	
Coal India	415.25	-0.18	8.24	0.88	
Adani Ports	1693.50	-0.24	29.74	1.11	
Adani Enter	3020.00	-0.38	52.29	0.78	
Max Healthcare	1070.00	-0.39	72.20	0.71	
HDFC Life	5456.00	-0.49	59.00	0.52	
SBI Life	1855.50	-0.59	71.57	0.74	
Apollo Hosp	8945.00	-0.66	64.22	0.82	
TataConsumerProduct	1082.30	-1.10	65.22	0.63	
Maruti Suzuki	14037.00	-1.23	30.79	1.63	
Sun Pharma	1945.00	-1.39	38.51	1.83	
L&T	4056.00	-1.48	28.43	4.22	
Cipla	1463.80	-1.62	35.24	0.73	
JSW Steel	1299.50	-1.72	11.35	1.08	
Eternal Ltd.	315.00	-1.97	702.05	2.03	
Asian Paints	2735.00	-1.98	54.24	1.10	
NTPC	342.50	-2.59	11.72	1.44	
Tata Steel	187.55	-3.16	20.79	1.38	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	256.80	-4.52	82.06	0.75	
Titan	4941.00	-5.14	86.45	1.81	
Kotak Bank	390.75	-5.23	19.15	2.56	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1115.00	-7.96	23.18	1.39	
Trent Ltd.	2897.00	-8.89	92.88	0.69	
Bajaj Finserv	2008.90	-9.75	15.58	1.03	
HDFC Bank	731.00	-11.04	13.64	9.96	
Axis Bank	1238.00	-11.30	13.78	3.16	
Bajaj Finance	1078.00	-39.12	32.51	2.57	
ICIICI Bank	1421.00	-57.14	17.06	9.05	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▲ 170.80 pts.
	Close(F)	Pts	PE	WN%	
Samvardmotheresoninternat	168.50	173.32	43.53	2.90	
Siemens Energy India .	3648.80	101.93	99.21	1.26	
Ivs Motor Cmp .	4440.90	44.99	58.59	4.06	
Britannia Ind	5510.00	36.29	52.31	2.53	
Ltmitndtree	4658.10	35.11	26.59	1.68	
Bosch	42950.00	23.95	45.68	1.45	
Rural Elec	367.00	19.96	6.03	1.78	
Vedanta	278.85	18.97	6.53	1.84	
Hindus Zinc	603.00	18.17	14.93	1.13	
Solar Industries	18855.00	16.80	97.18	1.77	
Adani Power .	209.00	10.61	27.73	3.07	
Adani Energy Solutions .	1630.10	9.64	63.36	2.08	
Tata Power	380.55	9.45	23.13	2.47	
Cummins India	5426.00	9.42	63.54	2.85	
Power Finance	420.00	8.46	4.12	2.38	
Indian Oilcorp	143.38	7.82	5.67	2.08	
Union Bank	183.60	6.18	6.79	1.38	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	879.00	5.98	111.81	2.34	
Punjab Natl Bank	114.81	5.10	5.96	1.54	
Zyduslifesciences	1114.20	4.51	21.88	1.08	
Hdfc Amc	2545.00	4.09	37.01	2.02	
Macrotech Developers .	1218.70	3.79	29.49	1.32	
Canara Bank	131.95	2.44	6.04	1.73	
Jindal Steel	1103.00	2.15	41.54	1.79	
Adanigreenenergy	1372.40	0.88	105.34	1.73	
Dif	642.00	0.00	35.74	1.60	
Muthootfin	2890.00	-1.31	10.13	1.21	
Bank of Baroda	250.70	-1.62	7.05	1.81	
Siemens	3940.10	-3.06	91.54	1.36	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	98.75	-3.16	16.13	0.69	
Mazagan Dock	2514.90	-3.33	35.55	0.74	
Ambuja Cements	434.00	-4.53	20.79	1.05	
Hyndal Mot India .	2200.50	-4.77	36.11	1.22	
Hindustanaeronautics	4910.00	-5.51	36.02	3.62	
Varun Beverages .	442.00	-7.95	43.85	2.35	
Shree Cement	26010.00	-9.13	57.36	1.35	
United Spirits .	1512.40	-10.82	65.21	1.74	
Indian Hotels Co .	731.00	-12.76	45.07	2.50	
Torrent Pharma	4920.00	-13.64	86.87	2.81	
Avenueusuper	3900.00	-14.61	83.20	2.44	
Bajaj Holdings	11263.00	-15.60	13.94	1.90	
Bpel	32.50	-15.80	8.13	2.53	
Tata Capital	370.30	-18.14	28.69	0.73	
Abh India	7600.00	-20.59	103.56	1.55	
Gall (India)	173.63	-21.71	11.57	1.82	
Pidilittind	1666.00	-23.41	63.13	2.00	
Divis Lab	8275.00	-27.33	75.10	4.09	
Godrej Consumer	1050.00	-31.88	57.72	1.64	
Tata Motors Cy	453.10	-39.15	55.10	0.62	
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1866.20	-92.78	27.66	3.14	

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.
India not in favour of
BRICS currency: Goyal



New Delhi: India is not in favour of a BRICS currency and does not support the introduction of any such scheme, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Friday. The BRICS group comprises 11 major emerging markets and developing countries of the world — Brazil, China, Egypt, Ethiopia, India, Indonesia, Iran, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa and the United Arab Emirates (UAE). “Bharat BRICS currency ke paksh mein nahin hai. Hum samarthan nai dete ki aisi koi BRICS currency jaisi nai vojna lai jaye. Bharat ka uske upar virodh hai (India is not in favour of a BRICS currency. We do not support the introduction of any such BRICS currency scheme; India opposes it),” he said after the conclusion of the two-day meeting of BRICS Trade and Industry Ministers in Jaipur. The remarks are important as in 2024, US President Donald Trump had warned BRICS countries against any move to replace the US dollar. [PTI](#)

Trump order sets 15% tariff, price floors on polysilicon imports

DOMESTIC FOCUS. The action is aimed at encouraging US production of the material and goods made from it

Bloomberg

President Donald Trump ordered new tariffs as well as price floors on imported polysilicon used in semiconductors and solar panels, warning that US reliance on foreign supplies threatens national security. Under Trump’s directive, imported polysilicon derivatives, including silicon wafers, photovoltaic cells and solar modules, will be subject to 15 per cent tariffs, beginning 4 December. The President signed the proclamation on Thursday. The measure also sets minimum import prices of \$21 per kg for polysilicon, \$100 per kg for polysilicon ingots and wafers, 22 cents per watt for solar cells and 38 cents per watt for solar modules. The action is meant to encourage domestic production of polysilicon and goods made from it, potentially helping nurture a US solar supply chain that has struggled for more than a decade to take root in the US.

The measures follow a series of US trade cases that have resulted in duties on solar equipment from China and some Southeast Asian nations. Foreign manufacturers have been found shifting production among countries to dodge tariffs. The new import fees also threaten to raise the cost of solar modules, another headwind for renewable power developers already navigating the loss of federal subsidies and a Trump administration pivot in favour of rival fossil fuels. Shares of companies with domestic solar manufacturing operations jumped in after-hours trading. First Solar Inc, the nation’s biggest solar maker, climbed as much as 8 per cent. T1 Energy Inc climbed 6.3 per cent. While the US was once a leader producing polysilicon in the early to mid 2000s, Chinese companies rose to prominence and by the end of the last decade were the world’s dominant producer. Firms with onshoring plans that win the administration’s approval will be



BIG PIVOT. US President Donald Trump signs executive orders related to the polysilicon industry at the White House in Washington, DC on Friday [REUTERS](#)

able to import some necessary production equipment and inputs without paying the newly-ordered tariffs. The delayed tariff implementation is a blow to US manufacturers that had warned it will give renewable power developers time to increase cheap imports and build a stockpile of duty-free equipment. **MOVE PRAISED** But Trump’s order says that the administration will police trade and act to restrict imports by companies found to be stockpiling. The move was heralded by manufacturing allies. US solar manufacturers, including First Solar, T1 Energy and Hanwha QCells, praised Trump’s action. T1’s chief executive officer, Dan Barcelo, called it a “decisive win for advanced American manufacturing and investment in domestic energy supply chains.” Trump’s proclamation opens the door to direct US investment in some cell and wafer manufacturers. The US has adopted other ap-

proaches in a bid to spur that capacity previously, including tax credit bonuses for developers that installed American-made solar equipment, but those have been phased out. **KEY MATERIAL** At issue are solar-grade and electronics-grade polysilicon — refined silicon crystals that are used widely in technology that powers modern-day life. Electronics-grade polysilicon is an indispensable building block for the chips used in everything from smartphones and medical equipment to precision-guided weapons. The tariffs are the result of a Commerce Department investigation, launched in July last year, that spanned both the raw commodity and its derivatives, exposing a wide supply chain to potential levies and import restrictions. It’s one of a number of probes under Section 232 of the US Trade Expansion Act of 1962, as Trump seeks to further domestic manufacturing capacity.

Social media accounts of foreign journalists applying for US visa under the lens

Reuters
Washington

The US State Department will vet the social media accounts of foreign journalists applying for visas to work in the US, according to a media report. The report in news outlet *The Daily Signal* cited an internal memo that said an initiative by President Donald Trump’s administration that requires applicants for many visa types to make their social media accounts public for screening was being expanded to include foreign media representatives. Applicants for another type of visa for workers from Canada and Mexico also will now be included in the screening, it said.

US LAW ELIGIBILITY A State Department spokesperson said what the department calls “online presence vetting” is used to ensure that applicants are eligible for a visa under US law. “The Department of State is screening to the maximum extent possible every foreign national seeking admission to the US to

The State Department uses “online presence vetting” to ensure that the applicants are eligible to get a visa under US law

ensure they will respect US law, including the terms of their admission and do not pose a threat to US security, public safety or national interests,” the spokesperson said. **NATIONAL SECURITY** “Officers use a variety of methods to make informed decisions that protect national security, prevent fraud and ensure a thorough review of applicants,” the spokesperson added. It was unclear when the reported new policy would take effect. The Department of Homeland Security tightened rules last month around how long foreign journalists working in the US, as well as other visa holders including foreign students, could remain in the country.



THE UNITED NILGIRI TEA ESTATES COMPANY LIMITED
(A member of the Amalgamations Group)
CIN : L01132TZ1922PLC000234
Registered Office : No. 3, Savithri Shanmugam Road, Race Course, Coimbatore - 641 018. Phone : 0422- 2220566;
E-Mail: headoffice@unitea.co.in Website : unitednilgiritea.com Fax : 0422 - 2222865

Extract of Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter ended 30th June 2026

Rs. in Lakhs

Particulars	Quarter ended 30.06.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended 31.03.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended 30.06.2025 (Unaudited)	Year ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
Total Income from Operations	1,982.60	1,631.01	2,215.14	8,335.36
Net Profit for the period from Ordinary activities before tax	771.20	429.88	918.32	2,593.12
Net Profit for the period after tax	637.51	366.32	802.13	2,194.35
Total Comprehensive Income for the period[comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive income (after tax)]	703.62	341.28	822.62	2,227.51
Equity Share Capital	499.66	499.66	499.66	499.66
Reserves (excluding revaluation reserve) as per audited Balance Sheet				23,629.21
Earnings per share (EPS) (Face Value of Rs.10/- each) in Rs. (Basic and Diluted)(not annualised for the quarters)	12.76	7.33	16.04	43.91

Note:

1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of **Quarterly Financial Results** filed with National Stock Exchange of India Limited under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

2. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results together with financial notes, Segment-wise Revenue, Results, Segment Assets and Segment Liabilities are available on the Stock Exchange website www.nseindia.com and on the company's website unitednilgiritea.com.

3. The Company has two Associate Companies incorporated under Section 8 of the Companies Act, 2013 which are not-for-profit Companies and hence not considered for consolidation. The Company does not have any subsidiary/ Joint Venture as on 30th June 2026.

4. The detailed Financial Results of the Company for the quarter ended 30th June 2026 can be accessed through QR code given in the newspaper advertisement.

Place : Chennai
Date : 06.08.2026



For The United Nilgiri Tea Estates Company Limited
Mallika Srinivasan
Chairman



Extract of Consolidated unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter Ended June 30, 2026

(₹ Crore)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Quarter ended 30-Jun-26	Quarter ended 31-Mar-26	Quarter ended 30-Jun-25	Year ended 31-Mar-26
1	Total income from operations	4,225.47	3,900.44	3,571.32	15,177.90
2	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before Tax, Exceptional items	692.11	744.42	633.24	2,823.31
3	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax and after Exceptional items	676.55	651.47	613.70	2,590.16
4	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after tax	504.52	451.77	452.45	1,861.47
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) & Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)	382.72	906.82	549.02	2,749.49
6	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face value per share: ₹ 1)	102.32	102.32	102.30	102.32
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	12,403.48	12,550.63	11,931.49	12,550.63
8	Securities Premium Account	1,487.20	1,487.20	1,463.79	1,487.20
9	Net Worth	12,505.80	12,652.95	12,033.79	12,652.95
10	Outstanding Debt	4,343.95	4,135.98	3,813.94	4,135.98
11	Debt Equity Ratio	0.35	0.33	0.32	0.33
12	Earnings per share (of ₹ 1 each) (Not Annualised)				
	Basic (₹)	4.93	4.42	4.42	18.19
	Diluted (₹)	4.93	4.42	4.42	18.19
13	Capital Redemption Reserve	1.46	1.46	1.46	1.46
14	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	6.55	4.39	5.76	6.09
15	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	7.75	6.94	6.92	7.45

Key numbers of unaudited Standalone Financial Results

(₹ Crore)

	Particulars	Quarter ended 30-Jun-26	Quarter ended 31-Mar-26	Quarter ended 30-Jun-25	Year ended 31-Mar-26
	Turnover	2,535.19	2,339.09	2,271.96	9,376.16
	Profit before tax	484.27	554.81	479.10	2,022.05
	Profit after Tax	362.72	421.61	354.69	1,515.61

Note:

1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites viz. www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com. The same is also available on the company's website viz. www.godrejcp.com.

Place:Mumbai
Date: August 07, 2026



By Order of the Board
For Godrej Consumer Products Limited

Nisaba Godrej
Executive Chairperson



Godrej One, 4th Floor, Piroshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (E), Mumbai 400 079, India www.godrejcp.com, CIN : L24246MH2000PLC129806



COFFEE DAY ENTERPRISES LTD.
Registered Office: 165, R.V. Road, Near Minerva Circle, Bengaluru - 560 004, Karnataka, India.
Tel: + 91 80 4001 2345; Fax: + 91 80 4001 2650;
Website: www.coffeeday.com
Corporate Identification Number: L55101KA2008PLC046866

Financial Results for the Quarter ended 30th June, 2026

Un-audited financial results of Coffee Day Enterprises Limited (Consolidated Information)

(₹ in Crores except per share data)

Particulars	Quarter ended 30 th June, 2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended 31 st March, 2026 (Audited)	Quarter ended 30 th June, 2025 (Unaudited)	Year ended 31 st March, 2026 (Audited)
Total income from operations (net)	293.20	293.48	275.28	1,154.40
Net Profit from ordinary activities after tax	4.52	132.07	23.28	210.14
Net Profit for the period after tax (after Extraordinary items)	4.52	132.07	23.28	210.14
Equity Share Capital	211.25	211.25	211.25	211.25
Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve as shown in the Balance Sheet of previous year)				
Earnings Per Share (before extraordinary items) (of ₹ 10/- each)				
Basic :	0.04	6.25	1.33	9.61
Diluted :	0.04	6.25	1.33	9.61
Earnings Per Share (after extraordinary items) (of ₹ 10/- each)				
Basic :	0.04	6.25	1.33	9.61
Diluted :	0.04	6.25	1.33	9.61

Notes:

1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Financial Results are available on the website of BSE (www.bseindia.com) and NSE (www.nseindia.com) and on the Company's website www.coffeeday.com

2. The above results were reviewed by the Audit Committee and thereafter approved by the Board of Directors in their meeting held on 06th August, 2026 and have been subjected to the Limited review by the Statutory Auditors of the Company.

3. Un-audited financial results of Coffee Day Enterprises Limited (Standalone Information)

(₹ in Crores)

Particulars	Quarter ended 30 th June, 2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended 31 st March, 2026 (Audited)	Quarter ended 30 th June, 2025 (Unaudited)	Year ended 31 st March, 2026 (Audited)
Total income from operations (net)	5.42	4.08	5.67	19.77
Loss before tax and exceptional items	7.00	130.50	13.13	173.93
Loss profit after tax and exceptional items	7.00	130.50	13.13	173.93

Place : Bengaluru
Date : 6th August, 2026



For and Behalf of Board of Directors
Malavika Hegde
CEO and Whole Time Director

CM YK A CH-CE

QUICKLY.

TN CM tells Assembly, 'I wanted to talk to DKS'

Chennai: Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay said that it was he who proposed holding talks with neighbouring Karnataka on the Cauvery issue considering some hope for a positive outcome. The Chief Minister declared in the Assembly that he did not wish to indulge in cheap politics on the issue. Responding to the Leader of the Opposition, Udhayanidhi, he asserted that there will be no compromise on the sharing of Cauvery waters or on fighting against the Mokedatu dam. **■**

India, Bhutan discuss trans-border river co-op

New Delhi: India and Bhutan reviewed the ongoing cooperation in trans-border river management, flood forecasting and flood management, data sharing and other areas during the bilateral meeting on cooperation on trans-border rivers between Union Jal Shakti Minister CR Paatil and Bhutan's Minister for Energy and Natural Resources Lyonpo Gem Tshering here, said an official statement. **■**

Centre creates 1,500 CDSCO posts for medical devices regulation

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

In a major boost to India's medical device regulatory ecosystem, the Centre has announced the creation of 1,500 new posts in the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO), with a significant share of the recruits set to strengthen regulation of medical devices, Drugs Controller General of India (DCGI) Rajeev Raghuvanshi announced on Friday.

Speaking at the 9th edition of India Medical Device 2026, Raghuvanshi said, "The 1,500 new positions will go to the medical device regulatory system in creating an internal scientific cadre for evaluating applications, hand-holding and giving advice."

A good number of those people would actually be from the medical device background, engineering background, software developers and AI experts.

Raghuvanshi said the expanded workforce would improve scientific capacity within CDSCO and support India's ambition of becoming a global hub for affordable medical technologies.

RECRUITMENT RULES

The DCGI said CDSCO had already established a ded-

India rejects US lawmaker's criticism of FCRA Bill

GOVT'S CHOICE. MEA says legislation is Parliamentary prerogative and an internal matter

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

India has rejected criticism from US Congressman Riley Moore of the proposed amendments to the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment (FCRA) Bill, asserting that the country's legislative decisions are an internal matter and several nations, including the US, regulate the flow of foreign funding.

Responding to questions at the weekly media briefing, Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said, "Legislative matters concerning India are its internal affairs. Decisions on such issues are taken by Parliament."

He dismissed the concerns raised by the US Congressman over the proposed changes to the FCRA framework.

OVERSEAS FUNDING

He added that regulation of overseas funding is not



MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal at a press conference in New Delhi **■**

unique to India. "I would also like to point out there are several nations, including the US, which regulate the flow of foreign funds," he said.

The remarks come following criticism from US lawmaker Moore over amendments to the FCRA, which governs the acceptance and utilisation of foreign contributions by associations, non-governmental organisations (NGOs) and certain other entities in India.

In a social media post earlier this week, Moore said the proposed amendment to

FCRA rules "is a clear attack against Christians. If this Bill proceeds in this way, it would be a point of major concern in our bilateral relationship with India," the US lawmaker added.

The FCRA Bill, 2026, introduced in the Lok Sabha on March 25 seeks to tighten government control over foreign-funded non-governmental organisations, appoint a 'designated authority' empowered to take over and dispose of an organisation's assets and foreign funds if its FCRA registration is cancelled, denied, or

allowed to expire. While it reduces the maximum prison term for violations from five years to one year, it led to concerns that administrative lapses or non-renewals could lead to the permanent, arbitrary seizure of civil society assets like schools and hospitals without adequate legal recourse. A PIB note said, "The concern that foreign money can, when unregulated, affect democratic institutions, electoral processes, and public discourse is recognised globally, and governments have responded with legislation."

'Medical device start-ups, large players can partner for mutual benefit'

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

Calling India's medical device start-up ecosystem vibrant but commercially fragile, Pharma Secretary Manoj Joshi on Thursday said many start-ups are struggling to take their innovations to market despite receiving government support, and urged greater collaboration between established industry players and young companies to help commercialise new technologies.

Addressing the inaugural session of the 9th India Medical Device 2026 in New Delhi, Joshi said India had witnessed a surge in medical device start-ups, particularly in the in-vitro diagnostics (IVD) segment. "We have a large number of start-ups, more in the IVD side, trying to make easy small devices which can be used at the PHC, CHC and village level."

Joshi said the government's Promotion of Research and Innovation in Pharma-MedTech (PRIP) scheme had received around 750 applications, of which nearly 500 came from medical device start-ups, reflecting the sector's growing innovation pipeline. However,

he questioned whether the ecosystem currently had enough market opportunities to sustain such a large number of start-ups.

"We gave a lot of grants under BIRAC and several other schemes. A number of start-ups have come up and they are finding it challenging to sell their product," he said.

Joshi proposed that "some sort of a partnership between a large industry and these start-ups can at least provide a market to some of the start-ups. Large industries can also take advantage of the product development which start-ups have done and buy those technologies."

He noted that such acquisitions and collaborations are common in the pharmaceutical sector but have not yet become a feature of the medical devices industry.

CLEARER STRATEGY

He estimated that nearly 1,000 to 2,000 start-ups were currently working in the medical devices space, and said India that needs a clearer strategy to ensure their innovations do not remain confined to laboratories.

He urged industry body Ficci to devote greater attention to strengthening market linkages for start-ups.

Home Ministry alerts corporates to WhatsApp malware behind 'Boss Scam'

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C) has alerted corporates and finance professionals to the 'Boss Scam' in which a WhatsApp account is taken over by malicious malware disguised as 'statement of account', 'MCA' and 'RBI' files.

Technical analysis carried out by the National Cyber-crime Threat Analytics Unit (NCTAU) of I4C indicates that the campaign is operated by organised networks acting across national borders and employs advanced malware with sophisticated propagation and detection-evasion capabilities through the DLL Sideloading method, the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) said in a statement on Friday.

Investigations are being pursued in coordination with the concerned law enforcement and technical agencies.

The campaign poses a particular risk to Chartered Accountants, Company Directors, Chief Financial Officers (CFOs) and finance and accounts personnel of companies. The MHA has advised



all corporate entities to immediately sensitise their employees, especially finance teams, and to independently verify through a direct voice call or in-person confirmation any urgent fund-transfer instruction or account-change request received over WhatsApp or e-mail. I4C has also come out with a standard operating procedure (SOP) to be followed.

PUBLIC AWARENESS

Citizens and organisations have been advised not to download, extract or open .zip files or executables received from unknown or unverified sources.

Regulators such as the RBI never distribute software updates, security fixes or account statements through

WhatsApp attachments, the I4C clarified. Regularly review linked devices in the WhatsApp application (Settings > Linked Devices) and log out of WhatsApp Web sessions that are no longer in active use. System administrators should enforce software restriction policies to block the execution of unknown .exe and .dll files from user profile directories, and ensure that all Windows endpoints run up-to-date anti-malware solutions.

Cyber fraud and suspicious communications of this nature should be reported immediately on the National Cyber Crime Helpline number 1930 or on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal www.cyber-crime.gov.in, the Ministry advocated. I4C decided to alert people after observing a sharp rise in complaints on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (NCRP) from different States and UTs relating to the Boss Scam. In the last few days, incidents following an identical *modus operandi* have been reported from multiple States, including Delhi, Gujarat, Maharashtra and Rajasthan, the MHA statement read.

AP unveils pedestrian safety policy

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

In a first among the States, the Andhra Pradesh government has unveiled a Pedestrian Safety & Universal Accessibility Policy, 2026, bringing together pedestrian safety, universal design, scientific road audits and technology-driven monitoring.

The policy, along with detailed operational guidelines, was approved by the Cabinet on Thursday to fundamentally change the way roads and streets are planned, built and monitored. At the heart of the policy is a decisive shift from vehicle-centric road design to people-centric infrastructure, with the objective of ensuring that roads are safe and accessible for all citizens, including children, senior citizens and persons with disabilities.

NEW PROJECTS

The framework will apply across the entire State and will cover new projects and the retrofitting of existing infrastructure.

The policy comes against the backdrop of a serious national road safety challenge. India recorded 1.72 lakh accident fatalities in 2023, including 35,221 pedestrian deaths, about 20 per cent of all road fatalities.

The Supreme Court has recognised safe and obstruction-free footpaths as a facet



of the Right to Life under Article 21 and called for a shift towards people-centric road infrastructure.

A major feature of the policy is the institutionalisation of comprehensive road-safety audits.

Roads, junctions, pedestrian crossings and high-footfall locations will be systematically assessed, while accident blackspots and vulnerable stretches will receive priority attention.

Locations will be assigned a quantifiable Safety Score, incorporating pedestrian vulnerability and universal accessibility parameters.

The framework envisages prioritising 15–20 high-fatality blackspots using two–three years of accident data, with at least 20 per cent of roads to be surveyed within the first year.

DETAILED STANDARDS

The policy lays down detailed standards for the

design of pedestrian infrastructure.

Continuous footpaths will provide a minimum 2 m clear walking zone, along with firm and slip-resistant surfaces, level continuity across entrances and side streets, and adequate headroom free from poles, signage and other obstructions.

Universal-accessibility features will include tactile ground-surface indicators, wheelchair-friendly kerb ramps, protective bollards, and Braille and audible signals.

At-grade pedestrian crossings will be preferred over inaccessible foot-over-bridges, with lifts to be provided where required.

The policy also adopts a zero-tolerance approach to pedestrian deaths and footpath encroachments, with local bodies, police and revenue authorities expected to work together to keep walking spaces obstruction-free.

RECYCLING DEBRIS

The policy mandated the use of processed construction and demolition waste for non-structural pedestrian components, including pavement and paver blocks, street furniture and certain protective bollards.

It also envisages incentives for manufacturers and contractors using certified recycled materials, with pilots intended to build local supply chains before wider rollout.

JNPA earned more despite lower volumes

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

The Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (JNPA) in Maharashtra has emerged as India's highest revenue-generating major port in FY26, despite ranking third by cargo volume, overtaking larger cargo handlers such as the Deendayal Port Authority (Kandla) and the Paradip Port Authority on the earnings front.

The port at Nhava Sheva earned ₹4,356 crore in FY26, accounting for 16.4 per cent of the combined revenue generated by the country's 12 major ports, according to government data tabled in Parliament during the ongoing Monsoon Session.

The Deendayal Port Authority, which reclaimed the country's top position in cargo handling by moving a record 160.11 million tonnes during FY26, ranked second in revenue with ₹3,437 crore, while the Mumbai Port Authority followed with ₹3,319 crore.

Together, the three ports contributed nearly 42 per cent of the ₹26,583 crore rev-



enue earned by India's major ports during the year.

WINNING FACTORS

JNPA, which handled a record 102 mt of cargo and more than 8 million twenty-foot equivalent units in FY26 emerged as the country's top revenue-generating port because of more cargo, expanded terminal capacity and technology-led operational improvements.

"The growth in revenue was driven by higher cargo throughput, increased vessel traffic, expanded terminal capacity and technology-led operational improvements," Gaurav Dayal, Chairperson, JNPA, told *businessline*.

HAL starts India's first satellite-guided navigation for choppers

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd's (HAL) airport in Bengaluru has introduced India's first satellite-guided precision navigation system for swift landing and take off of helicopters.

Described as a "Required Navigation Performance – Category H (RNP CAT H)" helicopter approach procedure, it has been developed by the Airports Authority of India, validated through flight trials and approved by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA), HAL said on Friday.

This approach enables all-



Category H approach enables all-weather access for helicopters while safely navigating terrain and urban obstacles **■**

weather access while allowing copters to safely navigate terrain and urban obstacles.

ENHANCED EFFICIENCY

The procedure reduces the approach time to HAL airport to about four minutes

from 12. Ravi K, CMD of HAL, said, "The operationalisation of the system is a significant milestone for the country's aviation ecosystem. This capability enhances the safety, efficiency and accessibility of heli-

copter operations and establishes a benchmark for similar procedures to be implemented at airports across the country."

"This system enhances airspace capacity, enables seamless integration of rotary and fixed-wing operations, reduces noise footprints over cities, and provides faster, safer routes for critical missions such as air ambulance and rescue operations," he said.

With nearly 50 helicopter movements daily at the airport, HAL Bengaluru has closed a long-standing gap in India's aviation infrastructure with this launch, paving the way for safer, smarter helicopter operations.

TN adopts resolution seeking fair share of Central taxes

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu Assembly on Friday unanimously adopted a resolution, urging the Centre to ensure that the State receives its due share of financial devolution of Central taxes.

Moving the resolution, Finance Minister N Marie Wilson said, "Tamil Nadu

has consistently contributed significantly to the national economy through sustained economic growth, industrial development, exports, sound fiscal management and substantial contribution to the taxes collected by the Centre."

Further, he said the devolution of Central taxes should be based on the principles of equity, fairness, fiscal effort,

governance performance and the developmental requirements of the States, while ensuring that the States that have successfully implemented population stabilisation and human development initiatives are not placed at a disadvantage.

The House also urged the Centre to ensure that the criteria adopted for tax devolution do not place any State at

a comparative disadvantage on account of its achievements in population stabilisation and human development. The resolution also urged the Centre to take appropriate measures to safeguard the legitimate financial interests of the State.

DMK's Thangam Thararu moved an amendment and supported the resolution.

Gujarat to set up 20,000 biogas plants in FY27

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Gujarat is turning cattle dung into a rural energy opportunity, with the State expanding its GOBARDhan (Galvanising Organic Bio-Agro Resources Dhan) programme to set up 20,000 individual biogas plants in FY27, stated an official release on Friday.

The initiative, being rolled out through the strong dairy cooperative network with support from organisations including the National Dairy Development Board, the Gujarat Cooperative Milk Marketing Federation, Amul, Banas Dairy and Dudhsagar Dairy, aims to convert livestock waste into clean cooking fuel and organic manure while improving sanitation in villages.

The expansion comes as the Union Cabinet has approved the National Circular Bioenergy Scheme – GOBARDhan with a total outlay of ₹23,731 crore.

Since FY24, Gujarat has operationalised more than 14,000 biogas plants across 88 clusters under the first

two phases of the programme. The State is installing modern 2 m³ flexible biogas plants made from durable HDPE material.

Each beneficiary receives a complete kit, including accessories. Under the Swachh Bharat Mission (Gramin), beneficiaries receive ₹25,000 in financial assistance for installation of a biogas plant, while contributing the remaining ₹5,000.

According to a UNICEF survey, a 2 m³ plant can save the equivalent of 8–10 LPG cylinders annually, enable scientific management of around 18 tonnes of livestock waste and reduce 834 kg of carbon dioxide emissions every year.

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thehindu **businessline.**

QUICKLY.

IndiGo, Embraer in talks for large regional jet order



InterGlobe Aviation, the parent company of IndiGo, is in talks with Embraer over a possible large regional jet order, sources said. IndiGo is considering purchasing dozens of Embraer E2 aircraft to replace its fleet of turboprop-powered ATRs as well as to bolster capacity, they said. The discussions are at an early stage and there's no guarantee of an order, they said. **BLOOMBERG**

Meta lists ways to curb deepfakes in govt talks

New Delhi: The government on Friday held technical rounds of discussions with Meta, and the social media giant explained in detail how it would address the Centre's concerns over deepfakes, child abuse content and unlabelled synthetically generated information circulating on platforms, sources said. **PTI**

SpaceX to build gas power plants for Texas factory



SpaceX plans to build its own power plants to support the massive semiconductor manufacturing facility it's developing in Texas with Tesla. "We're bringing our own power," Riley Trettel, who oversees energy and data centre development for SpaceX, said. "We're going to be building natural gas fired power plants, and we're going to be building very large battery arrays in order to store energy." **BLOOMBERG**

Saudi Arabia, Turkiye, Pakistan sign joint defence agreement

MECCA DECLARATION. The deal aims to strengthen collective deterrence against any act of aggression

Reuters

Riyadh/Karachi/Ankara

Saudi Arabia, Pakistan and Turkiye signed a joint defence agreement in Mecca on Friday, wedding Sunni Muslim US allies alarmed at a regional conflagration that has rained missile fire onto Gulf oil exporters.

Iran and its allies have been firing on Saudi Arabia and other Gulf states, and blockading their energy shipments, since the US and Israel attacked it on February 28 in a major escalation of years of regional tumult.

The agreement is intended to strengthen collective deterrence against any act of aggression and stipulates that an armed attack against any of the three would be regarded as an attack on all, they said in a joint statement.

While the statement did



STRENGTHENING TIES. Turkiye President Tayyip Erdogan, Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman and Pakistan's PM Shehbaz Sharif at the joint defence agreement signing in Mecca, Saudi Arabia, on Friday. **REUTERS**

not give specifics on the commitments or obligations each had accepted under what it called the Mecca Joint Defence Agreement, it said the pact was aimed at strengthening their collective security.

DEFENSIVE IN NATURE

A Turkish official said the agreement was defensive in nature, was not directed against any specific actor, was open to other regional

countries, and did not abrogate or replace any existing bilateral or multilateral arrangements.

"The political symbolism of the summit is significant. Three of the Muslim world's most influential states are convening at a moment of heightened uncertainty, demonstrating a growing willingness among regional and middle powers to co-ordinate more closely on security matters," said Ab-

dulaziz Sager, Chairman of the Gulf Research Center, a Saudi-based think tank.

"If institutionalised and translated into concrete co-operation, the trilateral framework could strengthen the three countries' collective diplomatic and defence weight while contributing to the emergence of a more regionally driven security architecture," Sager added.

Turkiye has NATO's second-largest military.

Saudi Arabia is one of the world's top oil exporters, while Pakistan is the only nuclear-armed Muslim country.

CRUCIAL TALKS

Their pact follows nearly a year of negotiations when Turkish Foreign Minister Hakan Fidan said Ankara favoured a broader regional security platform to promote cooperation and stability.

While Turkiye and

Pakistan, on the borders of West Asia, have avoided significant direct attacks, both are anxious to calm conflicts that threaten their own security and economic health.

For Saudi Arabia, the the conflict has imperiled its oil exports and development plans. Sealing Friday's agreement in Mecca adds symbolic heft to a pact that builds on longstanding bilateral military ties among the three countries.

Mansoor Ahmed, of the Australian National University's Strategic and Defence Studies Centre, said Pakistan and Turkiye bring strong defence industries to the table, while Saudi could contribute with technological spending. Pakistan has provided training and technical assistance to Saudi forces for decades, while Turkiye and Pakistan have exchanged warships and training aircraft.

India seeks China river data as Tibet dam raises concerns

Bloomberg

India is pressing China to resume sharing water-flow data as concerns mount over Beijing's construction of the world's largest dam on the Yarlung Tsangpo, a river that flows through India into Bangladesh.

New Delhi reiterated the need for an early meeting of the expert level mechanism on trans-border rivers and stressed the importance of sharing details of upstream river projects, Ministry of External Affairs said on Friday. India raised the issue

during the border talks with Chinese officials in New Delhi.

The two sides also reviewed efforts to stabilise relations and address long-standing differences along the border.

DAM WOES

China is constructing the world's largest hydroelectric dam in the mountainous region of Tibet at an estimated cost of around \$178 billion.

The project is likely to affect the local environment and downstream countries, including India, **Bloomberg News** reported.

Akasa Air ramps up ops with aircraft addition

Aneesh Phadnis

Mumbai

Akasa Air signalled quicker capacity expansion and rolled out a loyalty programme as it completed four years of operations on Friday.

Akasa Air operates 40 aircraft to 36 destinations and is the third largest domestic airline behind IndiGo and Air India.

"In the last 12 months we have added 10 aircraft and this pace will only increase. This month we are getting three aircraft," Akasa Air's Chief Executive Officer Vinay Dube said.

This year, Akasa Air has launched or announced five destinations — Navi Mumbai, Noida, Jaipur, Udaipur and Hanoi. Dube said the airline plans to add two more destinations in this fiscal.



IPO ASPIRATION

Dube said demand has held up despite higher fares amid a tough operating environment.

"In the June-end quarter, we grew short of 30 per cent which was great. Fuel cost was higher and we were unable to pass on the entire cost to passengers. However, we are pleased that demand has held up," he added.

Akasa Air's West Asia op-

erations were also less impacted compared to its bigger rivals Air India and IndiGo.

Jeddah, which is one of Akasa Air's main destination in West Asia, did not come

Airtel, Vi get SC notices after govt's plea against spectrum charge verdict

Vallari Sanzgiri

Mumbai



The Supreme Court on Friday issued notices to telecom operators Bharti Airtel and Vodafone Idea after hearing the government's plea against the quashing of the one-time spectrum charges by the Bombay High Court.

In June, the Bombay High Court had set aside the Centre's decision to levy a one-time spectrum charge retrospectively on telecom operators for spectrum held beyond 6.2 MHz between 2008 and 2012, providing major relief to Bharti Airtel and Vodafone Idea.

LIMITED NATURE

The Centre has since appealed against the verdict arguing that the government demand the charges considering the limited nature of the resource. After the hearing, the apex court asked for the telco's response on the matter.

While the court has not accepted the government's petition for a stay on the order, some experts view the development as concerning since the top court tends to support the government when it comes to revenue.

Parag Kar, telecom expert, said that it will be interesting how the Supreme Court rules on this matter after taking a hard decision on the earlier adjust gross revenue (AGR) case.

"In the AGR case, we saw the court go into the legal terms. What is the contract like? What is the document?" said Kar in a video.

Celebs boost digital endorsement deals

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani

New Delhi

Digital endorsements are playing an increasingly significant role in celebrities' brand valuations and endorsement portfolios, reflecting a structural shift in the market.

As per estimates by global financial and risk advisory firm, Kroll, for several top celebrities, digital endorsements contributed approximately 60-75 per cent of total brand associations by 2025.

The Kroll India Celebrity Brand Valuation 2025 report, noted that for celebrities, this shift is changing not only

where endorsements appear, but also how their commercial influence is built and measured.

For Shah Rukh Khan, who topped the charts as the most-valued Indian celebrity in 2025, digital endorsements' contribution to the overall portfolio stood at 65.7 per cent in 2025.

SECOND SPOT

Ranveer Singh, who retained his second spot in the brand valuation rankings, also saw digital endorsements accounting for nearly 66.1 per cent of this portfolio. For Alia Bhatt, digital endorsement's share was even higher at 76.1 per cent.

Umakanta Panigrahi,

Managing Director, Valuation Advisory Services, Kroll, said for celebrities, it signals a future where digital influence is becoming central to commercial success.

BRAND EQUITY

"While established names continue to command significant brand equity, digital-first engagement and new monetisation models are increasingly influencing the next wave of celebrity brands. As these drivers of influence become more diverse, measuring celebrity brand value requires increasingly sophisticated approaches that capture both commercial impact and digital relevance."

This comes at a time when the Indian digital advertising market reached ₹71,621 crore accounting for the largest share of advertising spends, the report noted.

LESS ON TV

Also, there is a tribe of relatively newer celebrities that are emerging whose endorsement visibility is primarily digital. "Celebrities such as Shanaya Kapoor and Suhana Khan are two of the notable examples for this emerging category. The analysis indicates limited TV endorsement presence, while digital endorsements account for a substantial majority of total brand association," the report added.

Fundamental duties & Vande Mataram on I-Day invite

Twin themes increasingly define the government's ideological messaging

Our Bureau

New Delhi

When the Defence Ministry sent out invites for Independence Day this year, guests found the full text of the fundamental duties of citizens under Article 51A of the Constitution and the complete lyrics of the national song *Vande Mataram* in Hindi and English.

The design choice is not merely aesthetic; it is an expression of the government's effort to embed constitutional duties and cultural nationalism as central elements of India's public life.

Fundamental duties, inserted into the Constitution through the 42nd Amendment in 1976, have increasingly been invoked by the government as the moral counterpart to Fundamental Rights.

At the same time, *Vande Mataram*, penned by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay and first published in his 1882 novel *Anand Math*, has acquired renewed official prominence,



SPECIAL EMPHASIS. The BJP has consistently sought to elevate *Vande Mataram* in public life through official functions, educational institutions and legislative measures

reflecting the BJP's longstanding emphasis on specific Hindu civilisational and cultural symbols associated with the freedom movement.

VANDE MATARAM

The government's push has not been confined to symbolism.

In the ongoing Monsoon Session, Parliament passed the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026, extending to *Vande Mataram* the same statutory protection that the National Anthem, *Jana Gana Mana*, enjoys under

Jana Gana Mana as the National Anthem.

However, in May, this year, the government endorsed the adoption of the full six-stanza version of *Vande Mataram* for official functions and government events.

NEW INSCRIPTION

The invitation card reflects this broader ideological trajectory.

Significantly, the image inscribed on invitation card is not that of the Red Fort, a symbol of Mughal rule, but of the newly-constructed Prime Minister's Office called '*Sewa Teerth*' that carries the Sanskrit idiom for public service *Nagarika devo bhava*.

By placing constitutional duties alongside *Vande Mataram*, the I-Day invite encapsulates the twin themes that have increasingly defined the government's ideological messaging: a call for civic responsibility rooted in the Constitution and a parallel emphasis on cultural nationalism.

NRB BEARINGS THE ORIGINAL
We Make Things Move

Quarterly Highlights Y-o-Y

STANDALONE

PAT 31.7%

CONSOLIDATED

REVENUE 19.2%

Extract of Unaudited Consolidated Financial Results for the Quarter ended 30th June, 2026

₹ in Lakhs

S.No.	Particulars	CONSOLIDATED			
		Quarter ended		Year ended	
		30.06.2026	31.03.2026	30.06.2025	31.03.2026
		Unaudited	Unaudited	Unaudited	Audited
1	Total Income from operations	37,500	37,899	31,946	1,36,952
2	Net Profit for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	4,877	5,579	4,500	20,123
3	Exceptional Items - gains / (loss) (net)	265	-	-	(703)
4	Net Profit for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	5,142	5,579	4,500	19,420
5	Net Profit for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	3,776	4,209	3,281	14,563
6	Total Comprehensive Income (after tax)	3,858	3,738	3,438	14,427
7	Paid up Equity share capital (par value Rs 2/- each, fully paid)	1,938	1,938	1,938	1,938
8	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as per Balance sheet -	-	-	-	96,366
9	Earnings per share (before and after extraordinary items) (of Rs. 2/- each)				
	Basic (Before Exceptional and/or Extraordinary Item)	3.60	4.27	3.31	15.61
	Diluted (Before Exceptional and/or Extraordinary Item)	3.60	4.27	3.31	15.61
	Basic (After Exceptional and/or Extraordinary Item)	3.80	4.27	3.31	14.73
	Diluted (After Exceptional and/or Extraordinary Item)	3.80	4.27	3.31	14.73

S.No.	Particulars	STANDALONE			
		Quarter ended		Year ended	
		30.06.2026	31.03.2026	30.06.2025	31.03.2026
		Unaudited	Unaudited	Unaudited	Audited
1	Total Income from operations	32,793	32,864	28,782	1,22,408
2	Net Profit for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	4,326	4,676	3,623	16,846
3	Net Profit for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	3,477	3,469	2,639	12,151

1 The above results were reviewed by the Audit Committee and then approved by the Board of Directors at their respective meetings held on 07 August 2026

2. The results have been prepared in accordance with the Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS) notified under the Companies (Ind AS) Rules, 2015 prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with rule 3 of the Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015 and Companies (Indian Accounting Standard) (Amendment) Rules, 2016.

Note: The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly/Yearly Financial Results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly/Yearly Financial Results are available on the websites of BSE <http://www.bseindia.com>, NSE <http://www.nseindia.com> and also on Company's website at <http://www.nrbbearings.com/>

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors

Place : Mumbai
Date : 07.08.2026

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors

(Ms) Harshbeena Zaveri
Vice-Chairman & Managing Director
DIN No. 00003948

NRB BEARINGS LIMITED
Registered Office: Dhanur, 15 Sir P.M. Road, Fort, Mumbai 400 001.
Tel: 022 22644570/ 22644146; Fax: 022 22640412; Email: investorcare@nrb.co.in
website: www.nrbbearings.com CIN : L29130MH1965PLC013251

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